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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

APRIL 15, 2025

[AUDIO & VIDEO ISSUES]

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, SO GREAT. COUNCILMEMBERS WE HAD, I WAS ENTERTAINING A MOTION TO ACCEPT THE SUPPLEMENTAL MATERIALS BY OUR CHIEF SPRAGUE, AND WE WERE JUST WAITING TO HAVE ENOUGH FOLKS TO RECEIVE THAT. AND I BELIEVE WE HAD A MOTION AND A SECOND.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: SO TO ACCEPT THE REVISED MATERIAL FROM THE FIRE DEPARTMENT. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: AND O'KEEFE?

>> YES.

>> BLACKABY?

>> YES.

>> LUNAPARRA?

>> YES.

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>> HUMBERT?

>> YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, EVERYONE. I WILL PASS IT OVER TO THE CHIEF FOR THE PRESENTATION.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MAYOR, MEMBERS OF COUNCIL, COMMUNITY. WE RETURN AFTER MONTHS OF COLLABORATION WITH THE FIRE COMMISSION, YOU, AND THE COMMUNITY. THE EMBER PACKAGE WE ARE BRINGING BEFORE YOU TONIGHT FOR CONSIDERATION. DEFENSIBLE SPACE, SPECIFICALLY ZONE ZERO AND ADOPTION OF THE FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE MAPS. THE FIRES IN PARADISE, SANTA ROSA, LAHAIE IN A AND LOS ANGELES AND BERKELEY IN 1993 AND 1991, THEY ARE NOT SURPRISES. MANY FIRES OCCURRED WHERE MANY FIRES OCCURRED IN THE PAST. FOLLOWING KNOWN TOPOGRAPHY AND FUELED BY WEATHER CONDITIONS. FIRE IS A NATURAL PART OF THE CALIFORNIA LANDS SCAPE. ONE WE CAN'T ELIMINATE BUT ONE WE MUST LEARN TO ADAPT TO. THROUGH DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HOME HARDENING WE CAN SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCE THE RISK TO LIFE AND PROPERTY. WHILE FIRE SUPPRESSION REMAINS ESSENTIAL, IT'S NOT ALONE ENOUGH. A SAFER FUTURE WILL REQUIRE ALL OF US WORKING TOGETHER TO MAKE BERKELEY MORE FIRE SAFE. THIS PHOTO SHOWS BURN SCARS, A TREE EXPERIENCE JUST UNDER TEN YEARS, ENDING AROUND THE TURN OF THE CENTURY WHEN WE BEGAN TO SYSTEMATICALLY ELIMINATE FIRE FROM THE LANDSCAPE. CLIMATE CHANGE FUELED IN PART BY WILDFIRES WHICH CONTRIBUTE 28% OF THE CARBON RELEASED INTO

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THE ATMOSPHERE HAS PUT A FINE POINT ON THE ISSUE. WHILE THE FIRE PROBLEM WE FACE TODAY IS PARTIALLY A RESULT OF CLIMATE CHANGE, IT'S ALSO THE RESULT OF THE SYSTEMATIC INCLUSION OF FIRE FROM THE LANDSCAPE FOR OVER 100 YEARS. THIS ALONG WITH OUR DEVELOPMENT INTO FIRE-PRONE LANDSCAPES HAS LED TO A SUBSTANTIALLY HIGHER AMOUNT OF REALLY DRY FUEL FOR FIRES TO BURN. AS THE CLIMATE WARMS IT PULLS MORE MOISTURE FROM THAT FUEL AND DRIES IT OUT, INCREASING ITS IGNITION POTENTIAL. AS THE RAINY SEASON CONTINUES TO COMPRESS, WE HAVE TINDER DRY FIELD CONDITIONS WHICH ARE EASILY IGNITABLE THAT OVERLAP WITH HIGH WIND EVENTS IN THE WINTER AND SPRING THAT DIDN'T PREVIOUSLY POSE A RINK OF FIRE. BECAUSE WE ARE NOT GOING TO ENGAGE IN A MANAGED RETREAT FROM FIRE-PRONE AREAS WE ARE FORCED WITH THE BINARY DECISION TO ADAPT OR NOT. MAINTAINING THE STATUS QUO WILL CONTINUE TO RESULT IN SIMILAR OUTCOMES. ALL OF THESE FIRES AND MANY MORE TOOK ADVANTAGE OF KEY VULNERABILITIES IN THE COMMUNITIES THAT ENABLED DEVASTATING FIRE BEHAVIOR, RESULTING IN CATASTROPHIC STRUCTURE LOSS, INJURIES AND DEATH. THESE VULNERABILITIES ARE WELL KNOWN, SCIENTIFICALLY SUPPORTED AND FIELD TESTED IN COMMUNITIES ACROSS THE WEST. MANY WITH SIMILAR TOPOGRAPHY, VEGETATION AND CLIMATE CONDITIONS TO THE EAST BAY. THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA EXPERIENCES ABOUT 8,000 WILDFIRES A YEAR. MANY OF THEM OCCUR UNDER FAR LESS EXTREME CONDITIONS THAN

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WE SAW IN LOS ANGELES. WE KNOW THAT FIRE WILL INEVITABLY AFFECT THE BERKELEY HILLS AGAIN AS IT HAS EVERY 20 YEARS WITH THE LAST MAJOR FIRE OCCURRING OVER 30 YEARS NOW IN 1991. COMMON PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT OVER THE LAST FOUR YEARS HAS OFTEN REVOLVED AROUND A COMPROMISE. SORRY, THE LAST FOUR MONTHS AS WE EVOLVED IN PROCESS, BETWEEN DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HOME HARDENING. ALLOWING FLEXIBILITY TO IMPROVE COMPLIANCE. IF I HAVE A HARDENED STRUCTURE DO I STILL NEED TO PULL MY CAMELLIAS. THERE ARE DOZENS OF PATHWAYS FOR FIRES TO SPREAD THROUGH COMMUNITIES. EVEN JUST ONE VULNERABILITY CAN IGNITE A STRUCTURE WHICH IS HIGHLY LIKELY TO RESULT IN THE ADDITION OF NUMEROUS IGNITION OF ADDITIONAL STRUCTURES AND LOSS OF A COMMUNITY. ESTIMATE TODAY IGNITE TEN ADJACENT STRUCTURES. DOING HALF OF THE EMBER HARDENING OR DEFENSIBLE SPACE DOES NOT TRANSLATE TO A 50% INCREASE IN IGNITION RESISTANCE OR STRUCTURE SURVIVABILITY. THE DARK RED POLYGONS SPANNING THE BERKELEY HILLS ACROSS THE PROPOSED GRIZZLY PEAK ZONE SHOW WHERE FIRE IS MOST LIKELY TO MAKE ENTRY INTO THE COMMUNITY. ONE STRUCTURE BURNING WITHOUT FIRE DEPARTMENT INTERVENTION WILL LEAD TO RAPID STRUCTURE TO STRUCTURE FIRE SPREAD. THUS EVERY OPPORTUNITY FOR EMBERS TOE RESULT IN IGNITION MUST BE ADDRESSED FOR THIS TO BE EFFECTIVE. ALL RESIDENTIAL CONSTRUCTION HAS SIGNIFICANT VULNERABILITIES, WINDOWS, VENTS, STUCCO WALLS ALL NECESSARY CONSTRUCTION FEATURES THAT MAKE ZONE

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ZERO AND DEFENSIBLE SPACE CRITICAL. THIS VIDEO IS FROM LOS ANGELES AND Its WHY HOMES BURNED. THESE EMBERS ARE BLOWN FROM OTHER VEGETATION OR OTHER BURNING STRUCTURES. WHEN ANYONE OF THESE LANDS IN SOMETHING THAT CAN BURN OR PENETRATES SPACE IN A HOME THEY IGNITE. ONCE A HOME IS IGNITED, IT THREATENS THAT NO FIRE DEPARTMENT CAN MATCH. THIS IS WHAT WE SAW. WE CONTINUE TO LOSE THESE FIGHTS BECAUSE WE FAIL TO RECOGNIZE THE MOST ABUNDANT FIRE FUEL ARE THE HOMES THEMSELVES. WITHOUT CHANGING WE CAN EXPECT THE SAME RESULTS.

>> FIRE IS OPPORTUNISTIC, IT EXPLOITS CONNECTIONS BETWEEN VEGETATION, HOMES, FENCES. SO I WANT TO SHOW A VIDEO WE HAVE CUT TOGETHER FROM A FIRE THAT OCCURRED IN 2016 IN TEXAS THAT SHOWS THIS RELATIONSHIP. I WILL NARRATE IT AS WE WATCH. THERE'S A TIMER IN THE TOP RIGHT THAT SHOWS THE PROGRESSION, EVEN THOUGH THE VIDEO IS CUT TOGETHER. SO ULTIMATELY THIS WAS A GRASS FIRE THAT IMPACTED AN UNMITIGATED COMMUNITY, NINE HOMES DESTROYED AND A NUMBER OF OTHERS DAMAGED. IT WAS IGNITED BY A LAWNMOWER THAT HIT MATERIAL AND CAUSED A SPARK. THIS LOW GRASS THAT WAS DRY. THE COMMUNITY HAD PRECEDING DROUGHT, TEMPERATURES WERE HIGH, THERE WAS ABOUT A 10-20 MILE AN HOUR WIND ON THIS FIRE. YOU COULD SEE IT SPREADING THROUGH WELL MAINTAINED BUT DRY GRASS. IT SPREAD THROUGH WOOD AND MULCH THE SAME WAY. FIRE IS SPREAD THROUGH THESE LOW FUELS AND IGNITE FENCES AS YOU SEE HERE. ONCE

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WOODEN FENCES ARE IGNITED THEY LITERALLY ACT AS WICKS MOVING FIRE THROUGH A COMMUNITY. FENCE FIRES WILL IGNITE OTHER VEGETATION IN THE HOME. YOU CAN SEE HERE IT'S ABOUT TO IGNITE VIA RADIANT HEAT VIA OUT BUILDING, ONCE THAT WILL PRODUCE. WE WILL START WATCHING THIS VIDEO IN THE CENTER. NOW YOU CAN SEE THE CORNER THE REAR OF THAT AWNING ON FIRE. THE REAR OF THE STRUCTURE IS NOW ON FIRE. AS WE SEE IN THE SECONDS OF VIDEO. THAT REAR OF THAT STRUCTURE IS NOW WELL INVOLVED. SO WITHOUT FIRE DEPARTMENT INTERVENTION, WITHOUT HOMES HAVING DEFENSIBLE SPACE, THIS IS ZONE ZERO AND BEING HARDENED. THESE ARE THE TYPES OF THINGS WE HAVE SEEN IN DECADES IN DOZENS OF FIRES ACROSS THE WESTERN UNITED STATES. WHAT IS THE DESIRED END STATE? I CAN'T MOVE THAT VIDEO OUT OF THE WAY HERE. I REALLY LIKE LOOKING AT THIS AS AN EQUATION. IF YOU CAN CONCEPTUALIZE OUR ACTIONS BEFORE, DURING A FIRE AS AN EQUATION, THERE'S THREE MAJOR COMPONENTS. ONE IS WHAT DO WE DO AHEAD OF THE FIRE. THESE ARE ACTIONS WE TAKE NOW, DISRUPTING THE VEGETATION TO MAKE IT HARDER FOR THE FIRE TO SPREAD. ENSURING OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT IS PROPERLY STAFFED, EQUIPPED, TRAINED AND MOST IMPORTANTLY, CREATING THAT DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HARDENING OUR HOMES. NEXT ARE ACTIONS THAT WE TAKE WHEN THE WORST FIRE WEATHER IS FORECAST. AHEAD OF ANY IGNITION, INCLUDING, THIS INCLUDES INCREASING STAFFING STRATEGICALLY IN OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT, ESPECIALLY THOSE THAT ARE

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MORE VULNERABLE OR NEED MORE TIME TO LEAVE OUT OF THE HILLS. FINALLY WHEN AN IGNITION OCCURS, IT'S KEY THAT IT BE DETECTED EARLY AND THAT EMERGENCY OFFICIALS TRIGGER EARLY ORDERS TO EVACUATE AND SIMULTANEOUSLY SUMMON AN OVERWHELMING RESPONSE FROM NEIGHBORING FIRE AGENCIES. THE EMBER PACKAGE THAT WE PRESENTED TO YOU IN FEBRUARY ACCOMPLISHES ALL THESE FACTORS. AND THEY ARE ALL WITHIN OUR SPHERE OF INFLUENCING CONTROL. THIS IS A RUDIMENTARY SLIDE BUT I THINK IT REALLY ILLUSTRATES THE PROBLEM. THIS IS WHERE WE ARE TODAY. UNMITIGATED COMMUNITIES, ESPECIALLY ON THE PERIMETER OF OUR CITY. IF A WILDFIRE APPROACHES THE CITY THERE ARE MANY RECEPTIVE FIELD BEDS AND VEGETATION AND HOME THAT'S ARE GOING TO IGNITE. THIS IS WHAT WE HAVE SEEN IN ALL THE FIRES, LOS ANGELES BEING THE MOST RECENT. WHEN WE HAVE A NUMBER OF STRUCTURES BURNING THAT OUT NUMBERS OF AVAILABLE OF FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES THEN WE CREATE THIS UNSTOPPABLE DOMINO EFFECT AND THESE FIRES DO NOT GO OUT UNTIL THE WIND CHANGES OR DIES DOWN. SO IT'S REALLY A MATTER OF CREATING MORE TIME. WHAT WE WANT TO DO IS CREATE A MITIGATED COMMUNITY AND FOCUS ON THE HIGHEST RISK AREAS ON THE BORDER OF OUR COMMUNITY AND INVEST THE MOST RESOURCES IN THOSE HOMES, IN THOSE RESIDENTS TO TRANSITION AS MANY HOMES AS WE CAN TO BE LESS RECEPTIVE TO EMBERS AND DIRECT FLAME. SO WHEN THE FIRE APPROACHES WE HAVE FAR FEWER STRUCTURES THAT IGNITE AND THAT SLOWS THINGS DOWN. WE'RE NOT

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GOING TO STOP THIS FIRE BUT WE WILL SLOW IT DOWN, PROVIDE MORE TIME FOR RESIDENTS TO EVACUATE AND ALLOW US MORE TIME TO ACCUMULATE MORE FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES IN THAT SPECIFIC AREA TO CONTROL THE FIRES THAT DO IGNITE.

>> THERE'S A REASON WE BELIEVE IN FOCUSED INVESTMENT TARGETING A GEOGRAPHICAL AREA. I THINK IT BEARS REPEATING. THIS IS LAHAINA AND COMMUNITY IS IN AFTER CHAPTER 7A OF THE BUILDING CODE WENT INTO EFFECT. THEY WERE BUILT WITH MODERN STANDARDS, AND ALSO DEFENSIBLE SPACE. THERE'S 205-210 HOMES IN THE COMMUNITY. IN THE DEVASTATION THAT STRUCK LAHAINA FIVE STRUCTURES IN THAT COMMUNITY WERE BURNED. ONLY FIVE. WE KNOW THIS WORKS FOR AN INDIVIDUAL COMMUNITY. BUT AGAIN WHAT'S EQUALLY IMPORTANT IS THE ROLE THIS COMMUNITY PLAYED IN THE REST OF THE FIRE TO THE NORTH. SO WHERE THE VILLAGE WAS THE FIRE HAD TO FIND AN ALTERNATE PATH TO THE EAST TO GET TO THE NORTHERN HALF OF LAHAINA AND KAHOMA PLAYED A SIGNIFICANT ROLE. KAHOMA VILLAGE IS ABOUT A QUARTER MILE WIDE AVERAGE DISTANCE BETWEEN GRIZZLY PEAK BOULEVARD AND WILDCAT CANYON ROAD. HERE IT IS IN CLOSE-UP. AND THIS IS NOT A ONE-TIME EVENT. THIS IS IN BOTANIA, CHILE, THIS IS A COUNTRY THAT DOESN'T HAVE THE FIRE FIGHTING RESPONSE OF CALIFORNIA. WHEN THE FIRE REACHED THE OUTSKIRTS OF THIS CITY THERE WAS NO FIRE DEPARTMENT AT ALL. HOWEVER, THIS COMMUNITY AGAIN IS A MODERN COMMUNITY THAT ANTICIPATED THE MODERN RISKS OF BUILDING IN

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WILDFIRE BUILT WITH DEFENSIBLE SPACE PRACTICES AND HOME HARDENING, FOUGHT THIS FIRE TWO YEARS BEFORE THE FIRE EVER GOT THERE AND WON. WE KNOW THESE TACTICS WORK WHEN THEY ARE DONE COLLECTIVELY AS A COMMUNITY AND THAT COLLECTIVE ACTION HAS IMPACTS ON THE REMAINDER OF THE CITY.

>> I WILL GO THROUGH BOTH ITEMS AND THEN WRAP UP AND GO FROM THERE. SO THE FIRST ITEM IS ADOPTION OF THE CAL FIRE, FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE MAPS AND ADDITIONAL DESIGNATION RECOMMENDATIONS THAT WE HAVE MADE. THIS MAP SHOWS THE IDENTIFIED FIRE SEVERITY ZONES FROM THE STATE, THERE'S THREE ZONE CATEGORIES, VERY HIGH, WHICH ARE THE RED AREA ON THE MAP, HIGH WHICH IS THE ORANGE AREA AND MODERATE THE YELLOW AREAS. IT'S IMPORTANT TO NOTE THAT CAL FIRE MODELING TAKES INTO ACCOUNT A VERY LIMITED NUMBER OF FACTORS INCLUDING URBAN VEGETATION BLOWING EMBERS, FIRE HISTORY AND DISTANCE THAT POSES A RISK. IT'S IMPORTANT TO NOTE WHAT IT DOESN'T MODEL. IT'S NOT A STRUCTURE LOSS MODEL. IT'S NOT REALLY WELL SUITED FOR PREDICTING FIRE BEHAVIOR IN URBAN ENVIRONMENTS. IT DOESN'T CONSIDER KEY LOCAL INFORMATION THAT IS REALLY IMPORTANT, INCLUDING HOW MANY STRUCTURES PER ACRE OR AVERAGE DISTANCE PER STRUCTURES IN A CERTAIN AREA. THE YEAR THAT HOMES WERE CONSTRUCTED OR THE NUMBER OF HOMES THAT HAVE UNDERGONE RENOVATION TO HARDEN THEM, INSTALLING VENTS, GUTTER COVERS, NONE OF THAT IS CONSIDERED. AND

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FINALLY, THE MODELING DOESN'T CONSIDER THE NUMBER OF PEOPLE IN THE AREA AND THE CAPACITY OF THE ROADWAY TO SUPPORT A MAJOR EVACUATION. I FORGOT TO MENTION, THE THREE CATEGORIES HAVE SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS THAT ARE REQUIRED BY STATE LAW, SO VERY HIGH, ANY AREAS VERY HIGH, WE HAVE TO ADOPT NO SMALLER THAN THAT FOOTPRINT. WE CAN'T EXPAND IT, SHRINK IT OR CHANGE THE REGULATIONS APPLIED BY THE STATE IN THOSE AREAS. VERY HIGH RED ZONE IS REQUIRED TO COMPLY WITH DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND IS REQUIRED, NEW CONSTRUCTION IS REQUIRED TO COMPLY WITH CHAPTER 7A. NEW CONSTRUCTION, NOT EXISTING CONSTRUCTION. THIS IS NOT RETROACTIVE. THE ORANGE AREA HIGH, IS ONLY REQUIRED FOR NEW CONSTRUCTION TO COMPLY WITH CHAPTER 7A, OTHER THAN THAT THERE'S NO REQUIREMENTS AND IN THE MODERN ZONE THERE'S NO REQUIREMENTS. SO WHAT IS THE HISTORY OF THIS PROCESS IN BERKELEY? THIS HAS BEEN GOING ON SINCE THE '91 FIRE. OUR MAYOR AT THE TIME, OR MAYOR BATES WAS THE ONE WHO CHAMPIONED THIS LEGISLATION AT THE STATE. ESTABLISHING THE FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONES. SINCE 1991 WE HAVE ADOPTED A MUCH LARGER AREA THAN THE STATE REQUIRES, AS SHOWN IN THE LARGE ORANGE POLYGON ON THE MAP. THAT AREA WAS ALL VERY HIGH. WE BROUGHT THE VERY HIGH ALL THE WAY DOWN TO ESSENTIALLY M.L.K. IN THE NORTH. SO I HAVE OVERLAYED WHAT THE CURRENT 2025 CAL FIRE RECOMMENDATION ARE OVER WHAT OUR AREA USED TO BE AND IS TODAY. AS WE REVIEWED THE CAL FIRE MAPS, WE LOOKED

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AT MODIFICATIONS WE WANTED TO MAKE AND IT'S IMPORTANT TO THINK ABOUT WHAT WE WERE CONSIDERING WHEN WE WERE MAKING THIS RECOMMENDATION. ONE IS FIRE HISTORY. AS I HAVE TALKED ABOUT, FIRE IS REPETITIVE, FOLLOWS KNOWN TOPOGRAPHY, PUSHED BY WIND CONDITIONS. THERE'S A NUMBER OF FIRES THAT IMPACTED THE EAST BAY HILLS OVER THE LAST 100 YEARS. AND THEY ARE ALL GENERALLY IN THE SAME AREAS. AND THEN WE DID FIRE PATHWAY MAPPING, SO YOU CAN SEE THE PATHWAYS GENERALLY ALIGN WITH FIRES THAT HAVE OCCURRED. WE LOOKED AT STRUCTURE SEPARATION DISTANCE AND STRUCTURE DENSITY IN THE HILLS. BOTH OF WHICH ARE IN THE HIGHEST RISK CATEGORIES AS DETERMINED BY THE NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF STANDARDS AND TECHNOLOGY. WHICH MEANS HOMES ARE REALLY CLOSE TOGETHER GENERALLY IN THE HILLS. THERE'S LIMITED RETROFITTING TO MEET CHAPTER 7A, WE KNOW THIS VIA OUR 9,000 INSPECTIONS WE DO EVERY YEAR. AND THERE'S ONLY ABOUT 50 HOMES THAT HAVE BEEN BUILT SINCE THE NEW CHAPTER 7A BUILDING STANDARDS WENT INTO EFFECT IN 2008. THERE'S ALSO VERY LIMITED EAST/WEST EVACUATION ROUTES WHICH WILL CONSTRAIN EVACUATION. AND WHEN WE ARE LOOKING AT WHERE TO DESIGNATE THESE BOUNDARIES WE ALSO LOOKED AT PULLING THE BOUNDARIES TO STRATEGIC NORTH/SOUTH STREETS THAT ARE WIDE AND IN A FIRE FIGHTING OPERATION WOULD NATURALLY BE USED BY INCIDENT COMMANDERS TO POSITION RESOURCES AND CREATE KIND OF LINE OF WHERE WE TAKE A STAND TO TRY TO SLOW OR STOP THE FIRE. SO ALL OF

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THAT HAS LED US TO A RECOMMENDATION AS WE HAVE EVERY TIME THESE CAL FIRE MAPS COME OUT, THAT WE DESIGNATE A LARGER FIRE THAN CAL FIRE RECOMMENDS BECAUSE OF THESE LOCAL CONDITIONS. SO WHAT YOU SEE HERE ARE THREE THINGS. THE RED AREA IS THE IDENTIFIED VERY HIGH FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE THAT WE MUST ADOPT FROM CALFIRE. THE ORANGE AREA AT THE BOTTOM IS THE CURRENT VERY HIGH FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE THE CITY ADOPTED AND HAS BEEN ENFORCING. THE PINK AREA IN BETWEEN IS WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING TO YOU TONIGHT WHICH IS TO DOWNGRADE THAT VERY HIGH FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE FOR THE REST OF THE HILLS, OUTSIDE OF WHAT WE HAVE TO ADOPT FROM THE STATE, FROM VERY HIGH TO HIGH. WE ARE ALSO PROPOSING TO SHRINK IT FROM WHAT IT WAS PREVIOUSLY AND THIS IS BASED ON ALL THOSE FACTORS I JUST MENTIONED. THE ONE PIECE ALSO IS PANORAMIC HILL IS CURRENTLY IN THE VERY HIGH FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE. AS YOU CAN SEE BY THE ORANGE AND WE ARE RECOMMENDING TO KEEP IT BUT SHRINK THAT AREA AS WELL.

>> SO THE SECOND HALF OF WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING TONIGHT, BY LAW THE CITY HAS TO ADOPT THE CALIFORNIA FIRE CODE AS A MINIMUM. THE DOCUMENT IN THE AGENDA PACKET ARE ALL OF THOSE LOCAL AMENDMENTS WITH CHANGES TO THE AMENDMENTS WE ARE DISCUSSING TONIGHT. THE MAJORITY OF THIS DOCUMENT IS EXISTING LANGUAGE AND AREAS THAT ARE UNDERLINED INDICATE LOCAL CHANGES. THE RECOMMENDATIONS TO AMEND THE CODE UNIFORMLY AND CONSISTENTLY APPLY THE BEST

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EVIDENCE WE HAVE TO MINIMIZE WILDFIRE LOSS. THEY ARE DRAWN FROM THE SAME BODY OF EVIDENCE BEING CONSIDERED BY THE STATE. THE VAST MAJORITY OF THE PROPOSED CHANGES ARE WITHIN THE FIRST FIVE FEET OF A STRUCTURE WHERE THE HIGHEST REDUCTION OF RISK OF LOSS IS POSSIBLE. WHEN COUPLED WITH HOME HARDENING. WHAT WOULD BE ALLOWED IN THE FIRST FIVE FEET OF A STRUCTURE WOULD BE SMALL PLANTS IN NON-COMBUSTIBLE CONTAINERS THAT COULD BE MOVED ON HIGH FIRE DANGER DAYS AS WELL AS MATURE TREES WHEN WELL MAINTAINED ARE LESS LIKELY TO SUCCUMB OR CONTRIBUTE TO WILDFIRE THAN OTHER SMALLER VEGETATION. HOWEVER WHAT WOULDN'T BE ALLOWED IS OTHER INGROUND VEGETATION, CLIMBING VINES, COMBUSTIBLE MULCH, NO NEW WOODEN OR COMBUSTIBLE FENCES AND WHERE EXISTING FENCES, OR TREE LIMBS THAT EXTEND INTO THIS ZONE. DEVIATING FROM THESE RECOMMENDED CHANGES WILL SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCE PROTECTION AND UNCOUPLE OUR REQUIREMENTS FROM THE STATE BOARD OF FORESTRY AND CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE, WHEREAS ADOPTING WILL PROVIDE NEIGHBORHOOD-WIDE CONTINUITY THAT STUDIES SHOW WILL REDUCE THE RATE OF LOSS AND COST TO INSURE. THE CITY WILL INITIALLY FOCUS ON THE AREAS WITH THE HIGHEST RISK, WHERE EMBER CASTS FROM VEGETATION ALONG FIRE PATHWAYS IS LIKELY AND SHOULD BE PRIORITIZED FOR HOME HARDENING AND DEFENSIBLE SPACE EDUCATION, INCENTIVES AND ENFORCEMENT. THIS ALLOWS US TO LEVERAGE OUR RESOURCES TO PROVIDE THE BEST POSSIBLE OUTCOME FOR

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THE HIGHEST RISK AREA. THE STRATEGY THAT BENEFITS THE REMAINING CITY AS WELL AS THE SLIDE FROM KAHOMA VILLAGE HIGHLIGHTED. WE DON'T KNOW HOW LONG IT WILL TAKE TO ACHIEVE THIS LEVEL OF PROTECTION AND STATE'S IMPLEMENTATION BY LAW WILL AFFECT THE VERY HIGH FIRE HAZARD SEVERITY ZONE WILL TAKE EFFECT IN 2029. IMMEDIATELY FOLLOWING APPROVAL, THE DEPARTMENT WILL PIVOT TO PUBLIC NOTIFICATION AND SUPPORT TO HELP RESIDENTS UNDERSTAND THE NEW LAW AND CONNECT THEM WITH RESOURCES TO GET THE WORK DONE. THE INSPECTION PROCESS IN 2026 WILL PROVIDE AN ADDITIONAL LAYER OF ACCOUNTABILITY, NOTIFICATION AND IF NEEDED, ENFORCEMENT. WE SHOULD NOTE HOWEVER ACTUAL ENFORCEMENT IS AND WOULD CONTINUE TO BE A LAST RESORT. IN FACT THE VAST MAJORITY OF VIOLATIONS ARE RESOLVED BEFORE THIS STEP. ONCE WE HAVE ACHIEVED COMMUNITY-LEVEL MITIGATIONS AT SCALE WE WOULD RETURN TO COUNCIL FOR ADDITIONAL DIRECTION WHERE TO INVEST NEXT. FROM WHERE WE STAND TODAY THIS WOULD BE THE NEXT LOGICAL PROGRESSION OF COMMUNITY INVESTMENT. IT MAY BE TRIGGERED BY GENERAL SUCCESS IN PHASE ONE OR MAY BE MANDATED BY THE STATE BEFORE WE GET THERE ON OUR OWN IN 2029. IN THE FUTURE THE FIRE DEPARTMENT WILL SEEK APPROVAL FROM CITY COUNCIL TO BRING ADDITIONAL AREAS OF THE HIGH FIRE SEVERITY ZONE INTO COMPLIANCE WITH DEFENSIBLE SPACE REQUIREMENTS UNTIL ALL THIS ZONE IS INCLUDED. WE SHOULD NOTE ALL THIS AREA IS CURRENTLY UNDER DEFENSIBLE SPACE REQUIREMENTS AND THIS PROPOSAL WILL TAKE

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ONE STEP BACK WHEN WE FOCUS ON PHASE ONE AND REINTRODUCE THE STANDARD TO MOST OF THE SAME AREA, POTENTIALLY PRIORITIZING THE YELLOW, GREEN, AND PURPLE AREAS TO THE RIGHT.

>> OVER THE LAST SEVERAL MONTHS WE ENGAGED IN A SUBSTANTIAL AMOUNT OF OUTREACH AND HAVE BEEN AVAILABLE, PRESENT AT EVERY REQUESTED GATHERING. WE PARTICIPATED IN TWO COUNCIL MEETINGS, DISASTER AND FIRE SAFETY COMMISSION MEETING, SIX COMMUNITY MEETINGS PRESENTED AT THE REGIONAL WILDFIRE COALITION MEETING, CONDUCTED TWO ONLINE COMMUNITY SURVEYS MET WEEKLY WITH IMPACTED COUNCILMEMBERS AND THEIR STAFF. AND WE HAVE ALSO GOTTEN THE WORD OUT THROUGH "BERKELEYSIDE", BERKELEY SCANNER, "NEW YORK TIMES", BLOOMBERG NEWS AND CITY OF BERKELEY EMAIL AND WEB MESSAGING. I WANT TO CLOSE BY ACKNOWLEDGING THE TEAM HERE BEFORE YOU AND ON ZOOM. ASSISTANT CHIEF ARNOLD, FIRE MARSHAL DREW WHITE, OFFICE EMERGENCY SARAH LANA AND MANY OTHERS WHO HAVE HELPED BRING THIS PROPOSAL TO WHERE IT IS TONIGHT. I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT GETTING HERE HAS BEEN A COMMUNITY EFFORT AND THE WORK WILL NEED TO CONTINUE TO BE A COMMUNITY EFFORT. THERE ARE MANY PEOPLE WHO HAVE BEEN INVOLVED WAY BEFORE EMBER BECAME A THING AND SINCE INCLUDING FIRE WISE COMMUNITIES, FIRE SAFE COUNCILS, NEIGHBORS, NEIGHBORING FIRE DEPARTMENTS, MANY MORE. WE ARE DOING WHAT I BELIEVE BERKELEY IS GOOD AT. RECOGNIZING A CLEAR AND PRESENT CHALLENGE, ANALYZING DATA, BEST PRACTICES AND MAKING DECISIONS

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THAT WILL GET US AHEAD OF THE CURVE. JUST LIKE WE DID FOLLOWING THE BALCONY COLLAPSE THAT CLAIM THE LIVES OF SEVEN PEOPLE AND SERIOUSLY INJURED ANOTHER SIX. BERKELEY IMPLEMENTED THE EXTERIOR ELEVATED INSPECTION PROGRAM, E3. WHICH INFLUENCED THE STATE SEVERAL YEARS LATER TO ADOPT STATE LEGISLATION. WE KNOW WHAT NEEDS TO HAPPEN HERE, THE SCIENCE IS CLEAR. IMPORTANTLY, FIREFIGHTERS HAVE EXPERIENCED WILDFIRES IMPACTING COMMUNITY THAT'S ARE NOT PREPARED CAUSING MASSIVE DESTRUCTION, INJURIES, DEATHS, MASSIVE ACUTE AND LONG-TERM ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACTS. OUR SENSE IS THAT AFTER LOS ANGELES, PEOPLE IN OUR COMMUNITY WERE IMPACTED SIGNIFICANTLY IN PROFOUND WAYS AND ARE INTERESTED IN ACTION. THIS IS GOING TO REQUIRE WORK. IT WOULD BE MUCH EASIER FOR US TO WAIT FOR THE STATE TO ENACT THESE LAWS. BUT IN GOOD CONSCIENCE, AS A THIRD GENERATION RESIDENT WHO LOVES THIS COMMUNITY AND AS YOUR FIRE CHIEF I CAN'T WAIT FOR ANOTHER FOUR FIRE SEASONS TO GO BY WHILE WE WAIT FOR THE STATE'S LAWS TO TAKE EFFECT. [APPLAUSE] I WANT TO SHARE THE BACKGROUND BEHIND THE SIGN ON THIS SLIDE. WHICH IS FRAMED IN MY OFFICE DOWNTOWN. I WAS 11 YEARS OLD WHEN THE 1991 FIRE CAME THROUGH IN THE HILLS. AT THAT TIME MY FAMILY LIVED ON HILLCREST ROAD, ADJACENT TO THE 24 FREEWAY. WHEN WE WERE ORDERED TO EVACUATE I HELP MY MOM BRING WHAT ENDED UP BEING A RANDOM ASSORTMENT OF THINGS IN OUR CAR AND WE SPENT THE NEXT SEVERAL DAYS WATCHING THE FIRE FROM MY UNCLE'S

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HOUSE IN EL CERRITO. WHEN WE RETURNED A NUMBER OF NEIGHBORS LOST THEIR HOMES. I REMEMBER VIVIDLY HOW UP ENDED THEIR LIVES WERE IN THE MOMENT AND YEARS TO COME AND I REMEMBER SPENDING DAYS LOOKING FOR ASH LOOKING FOR ONE UNBURNT PHOTO AND MEMORY. THAT MEMORY IS INDELIBLY IN MY HEAD AND THIS SIGN WAS POSTED ON THE DOOR OF ONE OF OUR NEIGHBORS WHOSE HOME WAS STILL STANDING BUT MASSIVELY DAMAGED AND I'VE KEPT IT ALL THESE YEARS. SO TONIGHT I'M HERE AS A RESIDENT AND YOUR FIRE CHIEF PROPOSING WHAT I FIRMLY BELIEVE IS THE RIGHT PATH FORWARD WE NEED TO TAKE. JUST LIKE AN EARTHQUAKE, THIS ISN'T A MATTER OF IF, IT'S A MATTER OF WHEN. THAT'S NOT SCARY, THAT'S EMPOWERING. IT PUTS US IN A POSITION OF CONTROL. WE CAN MAKE A CHOICE TODAY THAT WOULD OTHERWISE BE A CHOICE THAT WOULD BE MADE FOR US IN THE FUTURE. I APPRECIATE YOUR TIME. THANKS FOR THE OPPORTUNITY TO PRESENT THESE RECOMMENDATIONS. I LOOK FORWARD TO BOTH YOUR QUESTIONS, COMMENTS AND AS WELL THOSE FROM THE NEIGHBORS AND PUBLIC HERE TONIGHT. THANK YOU VERY MUCH. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU ALL SO MUCH FOR THE PRESENTATION AND FOR SHARING YOUR VERY PERSONAL STORY. I WANT TO START US ACTUALLY WITH PUBLIC COMMENT, IF THAT'S OKAY. I KNOW WE WILL HAVE LOTS OF THINGS TO SAY OURSELVES. IF FOLKS WOULD LIKE TO MAKE PUBLIC COMMENT, IF YOU COULD COME UP PLEASE. CLERK, IF YOU COULD GIVE US A SENSE, I THINK WE WILL HAVE JUST ONE MINUTE PER

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PERSON SINCE THERE ARE SO MANY FOLKS HERE TO SPEAK THIS EVENING. IF YOU HAVE NOT YET BEEN TO A CITY COUNCIL MEETING, FIRST OF ALL WELCOME. SECOND OF ALL, JUST SO YOU KNOW I'M A STICKLER FOR TIME. ONCE YOU HAVE REACHED YOUR MINUTE MARK YOU CAN FINISH YOUR SENTENCE AND THEN I'M GOING TO CUT YOU OFF, OKAY. THANK YOU ALL SO MUCH. COME FORWARD.

>> CITY CLERK: OF COURSE, YOU CAN YIELD TIME TO OTHER SPEAKERS UP TO A MAXIMUM OF FOUR MINUTES FOR ANYONE SPEAKER.

>> HI, I'M [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: COME ON UP TO THE PODIUM HERE. THERE'S A MIC.

>> THANK YOU. I'M RUTH AARONCRANTZ. I WANT TO SPEAK TO ZONE ZERO. OUR CITY IS NOT ALONE FOR MAKING A POLICY CLEARING COMBUSTIBLES FIVE FEET FROM HOMES. GOVERNOR NEWSOM IS REQUIRING CALFIRE. THE NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION RECOMMENDS -- [OFF MIC] FIRE PROTECTION IN THEIR PROTECTION. AND THE INSURANCE INSTITUTE FOR BUSINESS AND HOME SAFETY REQUIRES A ZERO TO FIVE CLEARANCE FOR THEIR WILDLIFE PREPARED HOME DESIGNATED PROGRAM. DO WE WANT TO HOLD ONTO OUR INSURANCE? WE DO. MICHAEL GONARD, DIRECTLY OF BERKELEY FIRE RESEARCH LAB AT U.C. BERKELEY SAYS WILDLIFE SCIENCE IS CLEAR, REMOVING COMBUSTIBLE MATERIAL FROM THE FIVE FEET AROUND A HOUSE IS AMONG THE MOST IMPORTANT MITIGATION ACTIONS A HOMEOWNER CAN DO. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANKS FOR YOUR COMMENT. COME ON UP.

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YOU DON'T HAVE TO WAIT FOR ME TO CALL YOU. MAKE SURE YOU ARE SPEAKING IN THE MIC, THAT YOU ARE CLOSE ENOUGH.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. MY NAME IS RHONDA GRUSKA. I SPEAK FOR THE PLANTS. I'VE ALSO BEEN PROVIDING A VENUE FOR CONVERSATION ON NEXTDOOR APP FOR NUMEROUS BERKELEYANS WHO HAD NO IDEA WHAT THIS WOULD MEAN FOR THEIR HOMES AND NEIGHBORHOODS. THANKS TO FIRE WISE GROUP MEMBERS LIKE MICHEL, I'M TAKING IT UPON MYSELF TO SPEAK FOR THE RENTERS LIKE ME, WHO ALSO CARE AND WILL BE IMPACTED IF THE PLACES WE LIVE AND OUR NEIGHBORHOODS EXPERIENCE A DEVASTATING FIRE. SOME PROPONENTS OF EMBER DO NOT ACKNOWLEDGE THAT THE OPPONENTS OF THE PROPOSAL WANT EXACTLY THE SAME THING. EFFECTIVE PUBLIC POLICY TO PROTECT HUMAN LIVES AND STRUCTURES IN THE CASE OF A FIRE. BUT WE CARE ABOUT EVEN MORE. WE CARE ABOUT THE ENVIRONMENT. AND FIXES THAT MAY HAVE UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCES THAT WILL LEAD TO MORE INTENSE WEATHER EVENTS. IT'S NOT A CASE OF IMPLEMENTING EMBER, AS OPPOSED TO DOING NOTHING AT ALL. AS THE ADAGE GOES, WE WANT TO WORK SMARTER, NOT HARDER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS ERIK WEAVER. I LIVED ON CRESTED ROAD FOR 31 YEARS. I'M A GARDENER, I'M NOT TOO HAPPY WHAT IT MEANS FOR MY GARDEN BUT I'VE ACCEPTED IT AND BEGUN THE WORK. OUR NEIGHBORHOOD IS EXTREMELY WELL ORGANIZED. WE HAVE 98 PEOPLE

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SIGNED UP. ON MARCH 23RD WE HAD A MEETING OF 60 PEOPLE. ALL 60 VOTED UNANIMOUSLY TO SUPPORT THE EMBER PROPOSAL. WE ARE WORKING WITH TUNA COLLEGE WHO HAS DONE EXCELLENT WORK ON THEIR PROPERTY. THERE IS TENDENCY IN THE LOCAL BLOCKS TO TRY TO MAKE THIS A HILLS VERSUS FLATS' ISSUE. BUT I WOULD LIKE TO POINT OUT THAT IN THE 1923 BERKELEY FIRE, THE FIRE BURNED FROM EUCLID DOWN TO SHATTUCK. SO ELIMINATING FIRE IN THIS NEIGHBORHOOD BENEFITS THE WHOLE CITY. WE NEED THE CITY RESOURCES TO HELP WHAT WE ARE ALREADY DOING ON OUR OWN. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI, I'M ERIK'S WIFE, SARAH SANDERSON. I'VE BEEN ORGANIZING ON MY NEIGHBORHOOD FOR 25 YEARS FOR EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS. WE ARE READY TO STAY IN AN EARTHQUAKE FOR FIVE DAYS. WE HAVE GOT NEIGHBORS WHO KNOW EACH OTHER AND WE KNOW WHO IS THERE, WE KNOW WHO IS ELDERLY AND WHAT KIND OF INCOME EVERYBODY HAS. BUT WE'RE NOT PULLING THAT OUT. WE ARE DOING THE WORK FOR EVERYONE, AND WE ARE DOING IT TOGETHER AND WE ARE DOING IT RESPECTFULLY. AND WE ARE STARTING NOW. SMOKEY THE BEAR SAID IT BEST. ONLY WE CAN -- ONLY EACH ONE OF US, AND WE WANT TO DO OUR BIT. WE ARE HERE AND WE ARE READY AND STARTING. AND WE ARE ALREADY HELPING OUR LOW-INCOME PEOPLE AND HELPING PEOPLE WHO DON'T HAVE THE RESOURCES OR ABILITY. SO WE JUST HOPE YOU WILL TAKE THIS FORWARD BECAUSE IT'S OUR COMMUNITY THAT WE LOVE. AND WE'RE A PART OF BERKELEY AND WE

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ARE A PART OF, YOU KNOW, WE WANT TO BE HERE AFTER THE FIRE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, ALL. HELLO COUNCIL MAYORS AND MAYOR ISHII. I'M ISABELLA, I'M A SENIOR AT U.C. BERKELEY. I WILL BE SPEAKING. I LIVE NEAR ZONE FOUR. I HAVE A COUPLE POINTS AS TO WHY I DON'T THINK THIS PROPOSAL IS TERRIBLY WORKABLE FOR THE RESIDENTS THAT LIVE THERE. I WILL SAY IT IS TOO HARSH ON HOMEOWNERS. ER THE PROPOSED NEW RULES COULD REQUIRE HUNDREDS OF HOMEOWNERS TO MAKE MAJOR CHANGES, REMOVING TREES, FLOWERS, VINES WITHOUT FUNDING OR FINANCIAL HELP FROM THE CITY, WHICH IN MY OPINION DOESN'T SEEM TO, NOT ONLY DOES IT NOT REALLY HELP THE COMMUNITY IN TERMS OF FINANCIAL STUFF, BUT RECOVERY FROM THAT, BUT A LOT OF ELDERLY, WE HAVE IN THE AREA WILL MAKE THAT TOUGH. THIS WILL MAKE US ALL BUT UNINSURABLE. INSURANCE FOR HOMES WILL SKYROCKET WHICH COULD DRIVE OUR LONG-TIME RESIDENTS OUT OF THE AREA. WE ARE NOT THE PROBLEM BUT ARE ASKED TO BE THE SOLUTION. POWER LINES ARE A RECURRENT CAUSE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, BUT YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU.

>> I AM 760 WILDCAT CANYON, I'M THE URBAN WILDLIFE INTERFACE, LOLA VOLEN, I'M HAPPY ABOUT WHAT YOU ARE DOING, I THINK IT MAKES COMPLETE SENSE. I LIVE NEXT DOOR TO 50 EUCALYPTUS TREES. ACROSS THE STREET ARE OVER 100 EUCALYPTUS TREES. THEY ARE NOT PROPERLY MANAGED AND CANNOT BE PROPERLY MANAGED. EVEN IF ALL THE LEAVES

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ARE REMOVED ON ONE DAY, ALL YOU NEED IS ONE STRONG WIND AND THE ENTIRE AREA IS COVERED WITH FLAMMABLE VEGETATIVE DEBRIS. SO I URGE YOU TO NOT ALLOW ANY HOMEOWNER WHO HAS MORE THAN TWO EUCALYPTUS TREES TO SELL THEIR PROPERTY IN THIS NEW ZONE WITHOUT FIRST REMOVING THE TREES. BECAUSE IT MAKES IT IMPOSSIBLE TO PROTECT THE LAND WITH ONE STRONG WIND. A VEGETATIVE PROPERTY WILL BECOME VEGETATION FLAMMABLE COVER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI. MY NAME IS GINA RIGER, I LIVE IN DISTRICT 6. I'M ADDRESSING THE ISSUE OF THE FIVE-FOOT DEFENSIBLE SPACE. I THINK IT'S A BIT DRACONIAN TO EXPECT PEOPLE TO RIP OUT EXISTING VEGETATION THAT DOES NOT POSE A FIRE HAZARD ON THEIR PROPERTY. YOU COULD HAVE SOMEBODY WITH A SUCCULENT GARDEN THEY HAVE TENDED FOR YEARS AND YEARS AND IT'S NOT GOING TO MAKE A DIFFERENCE. THE STUDY CITED THAT I READ BY TWO FIRE ECOLOGISTS STATE THAT THE MOST IMPORTANT THINGS REALLY ARE THE HARDENING IN-HOUSES, IT'S EAVES, VENTS, SCREENS, MULTI-PANE WINDOWS, AND ACTIVE FIRE FIGHTING IS ONE OF THE MOST IMPORTANT THINGS. THE OTHER ISSUE IS WINDY STREETS AND WE DON'T ALLOW ACCESS FOR FIREFIGHTERS TO GET INTO THE STREETS IN THE EASTERN PART OF THE BERKELEY HILLS. AND THAT'S GOING TO CREATE A LOT OF PROBLEMS. SO THAT NEEDS TO BE MITIGATED. AND I WOULD ALSO AGREE WITH THE EUCALYPTUS AND CREATING FIRE BREAKS AT TILDEN PARK.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU.

>> COUNCILMEMBERS, STEVE TRACY, ALSO A THIRD GENERATION RESIDENT. TILDEN IS OUR FIRST LINE OF DEFENSE. TILDEN PARK. CUT THE TREES. PAGE 136 OF YOUR AGENDA PACKET. JOHN HITCHEN A 27 YEAR VETERAN MANAGING TREES. THAT'S HIS OPINION, 27 YEARS. CUT THE TREES IN TILDEN. WHAT IS BERKELEY DOING WITH THESE OTHER AGENCIES? I HAVEN'T HEARD ANYTHING. COORDINATE WITH THE OTHER AGENCIES. STEP TWO, CLEAR THE CARS. ASSISTANT CHIEF ARNOLD, STRUCTURE PROTECTION IS NOT PART OF THE EQUATION, IF SOMEBODY IS STILL UP THERE. GET UP THERE, GET THE CARS OUT. THE ENGINE HAS TO GET THERE. THE PEOPLE HAVE TO GET OUT. GET THE CARS OUT OF THERE. NO ZONE ZERO. LUSH GREEN GARDENS REASON THE PROBLEM HERE. TAKE YOUR TIME, GUYS, DO IT RIGHT. THANK YOU.

>> GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS JANICE THOMAS, I LIVE ON PANORAMIC HILL, I'M 5'2. THAT MEANS THIS IS A GOOD ESTIMATE OF ZONE ZERO. OKAY, I'M A REALLY PRACTICAL PERSON SO I'M THINKING HOW ON EARTH I WILL CONTINUE LIVING WHERE I LIVE. AND BE ABLE TO IMPLEMENT ZONE ZERO. SO I THOUGHT, OKAY I LIVE ON A HILL. NOT EVERYBODY ON PANORAMIC HILL IS ON A SLOPE. MANY ARE THOUGH ON A HILL. SO A FIVE FEET OF CONCRETE AROUND THE HOUSE, I WILL HAVE FLOODING IN THE WINTER, DOWNHILL EFFECTS ON MY NEIGHBOR. THAT'S NOT GOING TO WORK. I DIDN'T THINK DIRT, GOT TO REMOVE ALL THE VEGETATION, I WILL HAVE DIRT. SO THEN, I THINK THERE'S FOUNDATION PROBLEMS

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FROM EROSION. AND THEN THE THIRD OPTION, I GUESS, IS ROCKS. AND EVEN ROCKS I WANT TO KNOW, DO THEY RETAIN WATER? THE GRAVEL, ALL THAT. THAT'S ALL I HAVE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. MY NAME IS NANCY GILLETTE, I'M A RETIRED FOREST SERVICE RESEARCH SCIENTIST. AND A BOARD MEMBER OF THE BERKELEY FIRE SAFE COUNCIL. AS SUCH, I KNOW WE ARE INCREDIBLY LUCKY THAT OUR BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT IS AT THE LEADING EDGE OF WILDFIRE MITIGATION EFFORTS. [APPLAUSE] I WISH THAT ALL EAST BAY CITIES WERE SO LUCKY. THE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT'S CAREFULLY DESIGNED EMBER PROPOSAL SHOULD BE A MODEL FOR ALL EAST BAY LOCAL JURISDICTIONS. THAT WOULD MAKE A DIFFERENCE. IT'S CLEAR TO ME AS A FORESTRY PROFESSIONAL THE EMBER APPROACH IS SUPPORTED BY THE BEST AVAILABLE SCIENCE AND IS SUPPORTED BY ALL MAJOR WILDFIRE NONPROFITS AND STATE AND LOCAL FIRE OFFICIALS. I URGE THE CITY COUNCIL TO SUPPORT EMBER, AN EXTRAORDINARY OPPORTUNITY TO AVOID ANOTHER ALTADENA OR LAHAINA HERE IN THE EAST BAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO. I'M SUSAN NUNEZ, I'M A MEMBER --

>> MAYOR ISHII: PULL IT UP, A LITTLE. THE MIC.

>> I'M A MEMBER OF THE WORKING GROUP OF THE TAMEL PAIZ FIRE WISE COMMUNITY. I'M HERE TO SPEAK IN SUPPORT OF THE EMBER PLAN. I

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RECOGNIZE THE DEVIL IS ALWAYS IN THE DETAILS. AND SO I COMMEND OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR ADDRESSING SO MANY OF THEM IN THIS PLAN. I JUST WANT TO SAY BRIEFLY, I'M FROM HAWAII, I HAVE LIVED HERE FOR OVER 30 YEARS. AND IT'S REALLY DIFFICULT TO EXPRESS HOW I FEEL ABOUT THE LOSS OF HISTORIC LAHAINA. EVERYTHING IS GONE. SCHOOLS, MUSEUMS, CHURCHES, COMMUNITY. GONE. I DANCE HULA DEDICATED TO SOME OF THE STRUCTURES THAT WILL NEVER BE, THEY ARE JUST THE STRUCTURES ARE GONE THAT WE DANCE TO. ON A WINDY DAY, A FALLEN POWER POLE STARTED A GRASS FIRE. IN MINUTES IT IGNITED HUNDREDS OF HOMES --

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP, UNLESS SOMEONE HAS A MINUTE FOR YOU. SHE HAS A MINUTE FOR YOU, YOU CAN CONTINUE ON.

>> THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I COULD TELL YOU WERE IN THE MIDDLE.

>> I WANT TO END BY SAYING IT SPREAD IN MINUTES FROM A GRASS FIRE, ONCE THE HOMES CAUGHT FIRE. AND WHAT THE EMBER PLAN IS DOING IS TRYING TO HELP US NOT HAVE A STRUCTURE-BY-STRUCTURE FIRE IN THE HILLS THAT COULD BURN TO THE SEA. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> I HAVE TO BRING IT DOWN. [LAUGHTER] HI, MY NAME IS MICHEL? (?) I'M A RESIDENT OF THE PROPOSED ZONE FOUR. I'M ONE OF MANY ORGANIZERS OF FIRE WISE GROUPS ON THE RIDGE. ONE RIGHT NOW OF SEVEN CERTIFIED GROUPS. OF COURSE I'M IN SUPPORT OF EMBER. BUT I

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WANT TO EXPRESS WE ARE NOT WAITING FOR EMBER. WE WANT THE HELP FROM EMBER BUT WE HAVE ALREADY STARTED DOING OUR WORK. ON APRIL 12, SATURDAY, THERE WERE 100 VOLUNTEERS ON THE HILLSIDE, WE COOKED 138 MEALS, WE WORKED WITH TWO UNIVERSITIES, WE WORKED IN COLLABORATION WITH THE CITY OF BERKELEY. WE HAD, I THINK, ABOUT 70 STUDENTS. WE CLEARED ABOUT 300 LINEAR YARDS. 250-300 LINEAR YARDS OF GRIZZLY PEAK BOULEVARD. AND WE REMOVE I ESTIMATE ABOUT 300 CUBIC YARDS OF DEBRIS. IT TOOK THREE TRUCKS OF THE CITY OF BERKELEY TO TAKE THIS OUT. YOU HAVE TO HELP US. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS GREG MURPHY AND I SERVE AS CHAIR OF THE DISASTER AND FIRE SAFETY COMMISSION BUT I'M SPEAKING TO YOU TODAY AS A RESIDENT IN THE BERKELEY HILLS ON A PROPERTY THAT HAD BEEN BURNED TO THE GROUND IN 1923 AND HAS BEEN REBUILT. RECENTLY I HAVE DONE HOME HARDENING AND I HAVE MORE TO GO. I STRONGLY SUPPORT THE COUNCIL TO SUPPORT BOTH MEASURES BEFORE YOU TODAY. FOR THE RESIDENTS, I UNDERSTAND THE PAIN AND THE COST AND THE DESIRE TO NOT HAVE TO TAKE OUT VEGETATION, TO NOT HAVE TO DO SOME OF THESE MEASURES. BUT THE ALTERNATIVES ARE IF YOU DON'T TAKE THEM OUT UNDER CONTROL, THEY WILL BE TAKEN OUT UNDER A FOREST FIRE. AND I WOULD URGE THE COUNCIL TO CONTINUE TO FIND RESOURCES IN THE DEPARTMENT AND I KNOW THE COMMISSION WILL TRY TO FIND RESOURCES TO HELP HOMEOWNERS. BECAUSE THIS WILL BE A

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HEAVY LIFT FOR US ALL, BUT IF NOT US, WHO? THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI THERE. MY NAME IS DAN LEIBERMAN, I ACTUALLY SENT YOU ALL A LETTER YESTERDAY. MY HOME IS NOT IN THE HILLS. MY HOME IS NOT IN A DENSE AREA. MY HOME IS NOT IN AN AREA THAT'S EVER HAD A FIRE. BUT WE ARE LABELED, EVEN THOUGH THE STATE AS MODERATE AS A HIGH SEVERITY FIRE ZONE BY THE LOCAL FIRE DEPARTMENT. I DO NOT AGREE, WE DON'T MEET ANY OF THE STANDARDS THAT WOULD REQUIRE US TO BE IN THIS ZONE. WE ARE CURRENTLY IN PHASE 3. I JUST HOPE WHAT YOU DO IN THE MOST SEVERE AREAS IS FINE, BUT I THINK THE MAP STILL NEEDS SOME REFINEMENT ON WHAT I WILL CALL THE OUT LYING AREAS. THAT'S WHAT I REQUEST. OH, ALSO, THE ORDINANCE HAS SOME CONFLICTS BETWEEN THE MAPS AND WHAT IT SAYS IN THE ORDINANCE. IT SAYS BOTH SIDES OF THE STREET ON A LOT OF THINGS BUT IN THE MAPS ARE ON ONE SIDE OF THE STREET. SO I JUST POINT THAT OUT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI. I'M RICHARD LIEDEN, I LIVE AT 574 VISTA MONTE. WHILE A GENERALLY SUPPORT HOME HARDENING AND APPRECIATE THE SPIRIT OF THE EMBER PROPOSAL, I HAVE A NUMBER OF QUESTIONS ABOUT THE DETAILS OF THEIR IMPLEMENTATION. I'M VERY PUZZLED FOR EXAMPLE AS HOW YOU DEAL WITH THE NUMEROUS PROPERTIES THAT DON'T HAVE FIVE FEET OF SPACE TO THE PROPERTY LINE ON ALL SIDES. IS THERE AN ANSWER THERE? SHOULD I CONTINUE TO SPEAK?

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>> MAYOR ISHII: YES, PLEASE CONTINUE, YOU DON'T WANT TO LOSE YOUR TIME.

>> I HAVE ALSO SEEN STUDIES THAT CAST DOUBT ON THE EFFICACY OF FIVE FEET OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE, COMPARED TO OTHER HOME HARDENING MEASURES. AND I HAVE SEEN STUDIES AS WELL THAT CAST DOUBT ON THE VALUE OF REMOVING RELATIVELY NON-FLAMMABLE VEGETATION ADJACENT TO, FOR EXAMPLE, CEDAR SHINGLE WALL THAT'S ARE HIGHLY FLAMMABLE IN THEMSELVES. MY TIME IS UP, OKAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, I'M A LIFE-LONG BERKELEY HILLS RESIDENT AND LIVE ON PANORAMIC. MY SON IS AT CALFIRE AND A SMOKE JUMPER IN THE HELICOPTER CREW. AND ONE THING THAT I KNOW TO BE TRUE IS THE CLIMATE IS CHANGING SO IT'S BAD NOW, IT'S ONLY GOING TO GET WORSE. I'M HERE TO SUPPORT CHIEF. I LOVE MY PLANTS BUT I LOVE MY HOME MORE. I WILL MISS MY REDWOOD FENCES BUT I WOULD MISS MY NEIGHBORHOOD MORE. AND I CARE ABOUT PEOPLE AND DON'T WANT TO LOSE MY FRIENDS. AND I THINK THAT FIVE FEET OF VEGETATION CLEARANCE IS PRETTY REASONABLE APPROACH. AND IT'S EASY TO DO AND I THINK IT'S THE FIRST STEP. BUT I WOULD ARGUE WE SHOULD DO MUCH, MUCH, MUCH MORE. IF YOU LITERALLY DRIVE AROUND BERKELEY, I THINK THE WHOLE CITY IS IN DANGER OF GOING UP IN SMOKE ON A WINDY, HOT DAY. SO THANKS SO MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

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>> HI THERE, I'M CYBIL HATCH, MY PROPERTY BORDERS ACROSS WILDCAT CANYON ROAD. I, LIKE, SO MANY OF MY NEIGHBORHOODS ARE 100% IN FAVOR OF EMBER. THANK YOU. I'M DOING EVERYTHING I CAN TO REDUCE FIRE RISK ON MY OWN PROPERTY AND THEREFORE REDUCE FIRE RISK FOR MY NEIGHBORS AND THEIR LIVES. I REALLY URGE YOU TO MOVE FORWARD WITH EMBER AND THANK YOU, FIRE DEPARTMENT, FOR PUSHING THIS FORWARD. WE REALLY APPRECIATE IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS STEVE ROBY, THANK YOU FOR ALLOWING ME TO MAKE COMMENTS. TODAY SUPPORTING THE PROPOSAL. LONG TIME BERKELEY HOMEOWNER LIVING ON WILDCAT CANYON ROAD AND DONE A LOT OF RESEARCH, INCLUDING READING THE SCIENCE BEHIND IT. TRAINED AS SCIENTISTS MY WIFE AND I SUPPORT THE B.F.F.'S PROPOSAL. WE SPENT MUCH OF THE LAST YEAR PREPARING FOR THE NEXT WILDFIRE NEAR OUR HOME. BY CREATING A ZONE ZERO AND HOME HARDENING, IN FACT WE ARE SO PROUD OF OUR WORK, YOU MAY FIND AN ARTICLE ABOUT THE WORK AND MY WIFE AND I. IT LOOKS GOOD AND MAKES SENSE AND WE STARTED THIS PROCESS A YEAR AGO IN JANUARY DUE TO A SERIES OF UNRELATED EVENTS. I'M RUNNING OUT OF TIME BUT BASICALLY WE LOST A FENCE AND HAD TO REPLACE IT. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, DARA SHER, I'M A HOMEOWNER ON GRIZZLY PEAK, BEEN THERE 30 PLUS YEARS. STRONGLY SUPPORT THE EMBER PROPOSAL.

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IT IS MUCH MORE LIKELY WE WILL LOSE OUR INSURANCE, AS MANY OF OUR NEIGHBORS HAVE, IF THERE'S A FIRE. OR IF WE DON'T DO HARDENING THAN IF WE HAVE A FEW PLANTS THAT, WE ARE VERY SAD TO SEE THEM GO, IT'S HARD TO TAKE OUT OUR CAMELLIAS BUT WE DON'T WANT OUR HOUSE TO BURN DOWN AND CREATING A FIVE-FOOT DEFENSIBLE SPACE IS ONE OF THE CHEAPEST WAYS. IT'S CHEAPER THAN REPLACING THE SIDING OR WINDOWS. WE ARE DOING THE THINGS WE CAN AFFORD TO DO IN THE SHORT RUN WHILE CONSIDERING A LONGER APPROACH. I WAS HERE FOR THE FIRE IN THE BERKELEY HILLS AND WATCHED WHAT HAPPENED IN LOS ANGELES AND HAWAII AND NORTHERN CALIFORNIA AND WE HAVE TO TAKE THESE STEPS TO PROTECT THE HOMES AND COMMUNITIES AND LIVES I CARE ABOUT. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> AFTERNOON, I'M CHUCK MURPHY, I LIVE UP RIGHT ON BY TILDEN PARK IN ZONE ZERO. I AGREE WITH MUCH OF THE EMBER PROPOSALS. I'VE LIVED MOST OF MY ACADEMIC LIFE AT A GREAT RESEARCH UNIVERSITY, 40 YEARS. BUT I HAVE TWO CONCERNS. ONE, IN THE AREA OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE, WHEN YOU LOOK AT THE LITERATURE THERE'S A BIG DEBATE, HOW MUCH, WHAT USE? AND FURTHERMORE, NO ONE REALLY CAN TELL YOU WHAT THE PERCENT YIELD IS. HOW MUCH WE ARE GETTING FOR WHAT WE ARE PUTTING INTO IT. CLEARLY HARDENING THE HOUSES, ROOFS, SOF ETS AND SO FORTH HAS A BETTER YIELD BUT THIS IS NOT A PRECISE SCIENCE. ALSO THE COMMENT ABOUT EUCALYPTUS TREES,

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THERE'S SO MANY UP THERE. SOME SEEMS LIKE A BAND-AID WHEN WE LOOK AT THOSE. BUT MY BIGGER CONCERN IS SIMPLY THE COST. THE COST WILL BE HEAVY FOR PEOPLE ON PENSIONS AND SOCIAL SECURITY. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>>

>> HI, MY NAME IS DAVID EDWARDSON, I LIVE ON CRESTED ROAD IN BERKELEY IN THE HOUSE I WAS BORN AND RAISED IN 56 YEARS AGO. THIS POLICY WOULD BE A MAJOR FINANCIAL STRESS ON ME. WE ARE A SINGLE-INCOME HOUSEHOLD, I MAKE $27 AN HOUR. TWO YEARS AGO I REACHED INTO MY RETIREMENT FUND AND PULLED $20,000 TO BUILD A NEW FENCE. IF THIS PASSES I WILL HAVE TO CHOP HALF OF THAT DONE AND TRY TO COME UP WITH MONEY TO REPLACE IT WITH CHAIN LINK OR WHATEVER. ALSO MY HOUSE IS VERY HARDENED HOUSE. IT'S MADE OUT OF PLASTER, I HAVE DOUBLE PANED WINDOWS WITH ALUMINUM FRAMES, COMPOSITE SHINGLE ROOF AND I'M WONDERING WHY THERE'S NO EXCEPTION OR DIFFERENT SET OF RULES FOR PEOPLE WHO LIVE IN HARDENED HOUSES LIKE THAT. ALSO I SPENT ALMOST $1,000 ON THREE TREES THAT ARE ABOUT FOUR AND A HALF FEET FROM NEIGHBOR'S PROPERTY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HENRY DINERO, PRESIDENT OF THE BERKELEY FIRE SAFE COUNCIL. BASED ON ALL THE SCIENCE AND DOZENS OF VIDEOS FROM L.A., IT IS

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CLEAR THAT GIVEN OUR DENSITY, VEGETATION, TERRAIN, AND WEATHER WE MUST GO TO WIDESPREAD DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HOME HARDENING. WHILE WE ALSO CLEAN UP AND THEN THE HIGHLY HAZARDOUS EUCALYPTUS GROVES IN AND EAST OF THE CITY. NO ONE OR TWO OF THESE ALTERNATIVES WILL ULTIMATELY PROTECT US. WE MUST ULTIMATELY DO THEM ALL. EMBER IS A STRONG STEP IN MOVING FORWARD. AND WE MUST PREPARE FOR FURTHER ACTION, AS CALIFORNIA AND THE INSURANCE INDUSTRY WILL REQUIRE. A FIRE IN TILDEN PARK COULD DESTROY AS MANY HOMES AS BOTH L.A. FIRES AND KILL MANY MORE PEOPLE. THE REGRETS OF LOSING OUR FAVORITE PLANTS, MYSELF INCLUDED, WOULD BE FAR OUTWEIGHED BY SUCH A CATASTROPHE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MAYOR, COUNCILMEMBERS, AMAZING FIREFIGHTERS, MY NAME IS ALLISON BANKS AND I LIVE ON GRIZZLY PEAK IN DISTRICT 6, STATION 7 TERRITORY. AND I'M HERE TO URGE YOU TO VOTE YES ON THE EMBER INITIATIVE. I CAME TO BERKELEY RIGHT AFTER COLLEGE IN 1992, TEN YEARS AGO I FINALLY BOUGHT MY DREAM HOUSE IN THE HILLS. IT'S THE PLACE I WANTED TO GROW OLD IN, AND YEAH, SOME DAY DIE IN. BUT LATELY I LIE AWAKE AT NIGHT WONDERING IF IT WON'T BE AGE OR STAIRS THAT GET ME, BUT FIRE. I SEE THE EUCALYPTUS OUT MY WINDOW. I SEE THE NARROW CAR-PARKED ROADS AND I HEAR MY ADULT-AGED CHILDREN BEGGING ME TO MOVE, TELLING ME IT'S NOT SAFE TO STAY. THAT BREAKS MY HEART, I LOVE MY HOME, I

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LOVE MY COMMUNITY. I TEAR UP MY CAMELLIA, RO DO DENDRON, ANYTHING TO PROTECT IT. BECAUSE IF A FIRE COMES THEY WILL BE GONE ANYWAY. VOTE YES ON THE EMBER INITIATIVE, LET'S ACT NOW.

>> THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> GEORGE VELEZ, 20 YEAR RESIDENT OF THE BERKELEY HILLS. A BINARY SOLUTION IS NOT ACCEPT, THAT'S A ZERO ZONE PROPOSITION. 850-1,000 HOMES IMPACTED, POSSIBLE COST TO HOMEOWNERS COULD RANGE BETWEEN LOWER ESTIMATE OF $2 MILLION TO $10 MILLION DEPENDING ON THE AMOUNT OF CLEARING AND WORK. WHERE IS THE IMPACT STUDY WITH THE IMPACT TO HOMEOWNERS. ESPECIALLY TO FIXED INCOME, ELDERLY AND RETIRED HOMEOWNERS. IF YOU INSIST ON MOVING FORWARD WITH THIS POLICY, YOU MUST CREATE A MITIGATION FUND, CREATE A LIST OF VETTED LANDSCAPE SERVICE, CONTRACTORS WITH PRICING TO AVOID PRICE GOUGING. ASSIGN INSPECTORS, TO MAKE SURE THEY DON'T OVER OR UNDERESTIMATE. PRIORITIZE THE UNDERGROUNDING OF UTILITY LINES TO ELIMINATE HAZARDOUS CONDITIONS. TO DO THIS WITHOUT THESE STIPULATIONS WOULD OPEN YOU UP TO LITIGATION, AND BY THE WAY, FIRE DOES JUMP FIVE FEET.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI, MY NAME IS ALLISON KIDDER AND I'M THE RESIDENT LEADER OF CITY OF BERKELEY'S FIRST FIRE WISE COMMUNITY. MY HUSBAND DOUG AND I HAVE BEEN, WE LIVE IN THE BERKELEY HILLS AND WE HAVE BEEN

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WORKING VERY HARD TO HARDEN OUR HOME. AND MOST RECENTLY ESTABLISH AND SUCCESSFUL ESTABLISH OUR ZONE ZERO. THE ONLY THING WE NEED TO DO LEFT IS THE DECK AND THE GATES. AT ANY RATE, I JUST WANTED TO SUPPORT THIS MEASURE OR ENCOURAGE YOU TO VOTE YES AND ADOPT THESE STANDARDS AND I THINK IT'S IMPORTANT AS THE PERSON SAID BEFORE, MY MANTRA, I'M AN AVID GARDENER. AS THE PERSON SAID BEFORE I WOULD RATHER HAVE MY HOUSE AND NOT MY PLANTS. AND YOU COULD HAVE A REALLY GOOD POLLINATOR GARDEN WITHOUT ZONE ZERO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI, I'M MICHAEL CULLEN, I LIVE ON BUENA VISTA WAY IN NORTH BERKELEY. I WANT TO COMMEND. THERE'S MUCH MORE EVIDENCE ON HOME HARDENING THAT THAT IS REALLY ONE OF THE PRIORITIES WE NEED TO FOLLOW. THAT NOT ONE SIZE FITS ALL FOR THE EMBER PROPOSAL FOR THE DEFENSIBLE SPACE. AND ALSO IN TERMS OF HUMIDITY AND RETENTION OF BEAUTY AND OF THE KINDS OF THINGS THAT BERKELEY IS REALLY KNOWN FOR, I THINK WE ARE GOING TO BE TEARING UP OUR OWN ENVIRONMENTS AND POSSIBLY CREATING MORE UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCES. AND THE DATA JUST SEEMS TO BE MUCH CLEARER ON THE HOME HARDENING. I ALSO FEEL LIKE THE NOTION THAT THE COST HAS NOT BEEN CONSIDERED, THERE CAN BE INEQUITIES IN PROMULGATING A PROPOSAL LIKE THIS. AND I DON'T KNOW THAT'S THE SOLUTION WE NEED. THANK YOU.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANKS.

>> HELLO, EVERYONE. MY NAME IS -- HERMOAN, I LIVE CLOSE TO THE GOLF COURSE IN ZONE ZERO. I'VE BEEN LIVING IN THIS HOUSE FOR THE LAST 16 YEARS. MY KIDS GREW UP THERE AND I WANT TO KEEP IT. THE SUPPORT THE EMBERS PROGRAM BUT WITH SOME RESERVATIONS. I URGE THE COUNCIL TO THINK ABOUT TWO THINGS ALREADY SAID. ONE IS THE SUBTLETIES BETWEEN FLAMMABLE PLANTS. I TOOK OUT THE GRASSES, THE JUNIPERS, BUT WHEN THE FULL INSPECTION OF THE FIRE MARSHAL CAME BY, HE SAID THOSE ARE GREAT CAMELLIAS, WATER-RETAINING FLOWERING PLANTS. I THINK IT'S REALLY IMPORTANT WE REPLACE A LOT OF THE FLAMMABLE PLANTS AND THINGS THAT ARE LESS FLAMMABLE. SECONDLY, IT WILL BE A BIG COST TO TAKE OUT A WOODEN FENCE YOU JUST BELT OR DECK, AND NOT ALL OF US HAVE PROP 13 TAXES, SOME OF US HAVE TO PAY A LOT OF PROPERTY TAXES SO PLEASE INVEST IN THE COST SO WE CAN COVER THESE IMPORTANT CHANGES AND THEN WE CAN ALL DO IT AND GET IT DONE TOGETHER. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI. THANK YOU TO THE COUNCIL AND THE MAYOR AND TO THE FIRE DEPARTMENT REPRESENTATIVES HERE. WHILE I APPRECIATE THE GOOD INTENTIONS OF EMBER, I HAVE COME TO SPEAK ABOUT SOME RESERVATIONS I HAVE. MY NAME IS CAROL SIMPSON, I'M A HOMEOWNER ON CRESTON ROAD. I'M A FIFTH GENERATION CALIFORNIA, THIRD GENERATION BERKELEYAN. I REMEMBER THE 1991 FIRE. I'VE SEEN A

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LOT. HOWEVER, I'M CONCERNED THAT EMBER AND THE DISCUSSION IN GENERAL HAS LEFT TWO ELEPHANTS IN THE ROOM UNADDRESSED. PG AND E'S REFUSAL OR RELUCTANCE, SLOWNESS IN UNDERGROUNDING MORE POWER LINES IN THE HILLS AND THE PRESENCE OF THE DANGERS OF FIRE IN TILDEN PARK. I DON'T THINK WE AS A NEIGHBORHOOD OR ZONE SHOULD BE HELD RESPONSIBLE AND HAVE THE BURDEN OF THOSE TWO UNADDRESSED PROBLEMS. THANK YOU VERY MUCH. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI, I'M ALEX SINCLAIR.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COULD YOU PUT THE MIC A LITTLE HIGHER.

>> GRIZZLY PEAK, HAVE BEEN FOR ABOUT 30 YEARS. I FEEL THE EMBER PROPOSAL IS WELL-INTENTIONED. I WOULD LIKE TO URGE THE COUNCIL TO VOTE AGAINST IT. SO FOR MANY REASONS ALREADY MENTIONED, THE SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE IS AT BEST INCONCLUSIVE AND NOT SUFFICIENT TO JUSTIFY SUCH A MASSIVE ORDINANCE WITHOUT FURTHER INVESTIGATION. THE COSTS ARE ABSOLUTELY MASSIVE, AS WE HAVE HEARD. JUST ABOUT EVERY FENCE AND HEDGE WOULD HAVE TO COME DOWN BETWEEN PROPERTIES AND HILLS. THE PROJECT PLACES AN UNFAIR BURDEN ON A RELATIVELY SMALL SECTION OF BERKELEY POPULATION FOR PROTECTING THE REST OF THE CITY. PEOPLE IN THE HILLS ARE FACING A DOUBLE WHAMMY FROM INSURANCE ON ONE END AND FIRE DEPARTMENT ON THE OTHER. FINALLY, THE ONE-SIZE-FITS-ALL NATURE OF THE ORDINANCE DOESN'T LEAVE ROOM FOR COMMON SENSE. WE HAVE HEARD

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ABOUT PLANTS AND SITE-SPECIFIC --

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY. THANK YOU.

>> HI, THANK YOU FOR THIS OPPORTUNITY, MY NAME IS LISA, I'M A HOMEOWNER. JUST WEST OF GRIZZLY PEAK. I'M SO GRATEFUL TO THE FIRE DEPARTMENT, THANK YOU, GUYS. THANK YOU. THAT SAID I'M ALSO A SCIENTIST. I HAVE READ DEEPLY THE VARIOUS CITATIONS. THE SCIENCE IS NOT SETTLED. IT'S AN EVOLVING MATTER. IN FACT, THE LOS ANGELES FIRES WERE IN RECENT MEMORY. WE HAVE NOT YET LEARNED THE LESSONS FROM THAT FIRE. IT'S EVOLVING IN CONTRADICTORY, I SHOULD SAY, MY HOME IS HARDENED AND ALWAYS WET BECAUSE IT'S SURROUNDED BY REDWOODS, THANK GOODNESS. THIS IS, AGAIN, THE ONE-SIZE-FITS-ALL POLICY OF THE ZONE ZERO, I THINK IS, SHOULD BE CHANGED. SHOULD BE CHANGED. AND ZONE ZERO, WHAT WE SHOULD DO FIRST. HOW ABOUT ENFORCING FIRE TRUCK SAFE PASSAGE. GET THOSE CARS OUT OF THE WAY. HOW DO YOU GUYS GET UP THERE?

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP, ACTUALLY. THANK YOU. THANKS FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS GAN TRACK? (?) I HAVE PROBABLY FLOODED ALL YOUR EMAILS WITH MY SUPPORT FOR EMBER IN THE PAST. I'M HERE TO SAY I REALLY DON'T WANT US TO DELAY ANY LONGER. YES, I AGREE WE SHOULD UNDERGROUND MORE OF THE POWER LINES IN OUR NEIGHBORHOOD. WE SHOULD TAKE MORE EFFORT TO REDUCE FUEL IN TILDEN PARK, BUT WE SHOULD ALSO DO WHAT WE CAN WITHIN OUR NEIGHBORHOOD. AND SO, I

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HAVE DONE EVERYTHING THAT I CAN IN MY HOME. I HAVE HARDENED IT. AND NOW I'M GOING TO REMOVE MY FAVORITE PLANTS I HAVE TENDED FOR 24 YEARS. THAT'S HOW LONG I HAVE LIVED THERE. AND THAT IS BECAUSE I DO NOT WANT MY NEIGHBORHOOD TO BURN DOWN. I WANT MY NEIGHBORS TO BE SAFE. I WANT THEM TO HAVE A HOME TO RETURN TO. AND SO, I URGE YOU NOT TO DELAY ANY FURTHER. CERTAINLY, AS WE LEARN NEW THINGS WE CAN EVOLVE THE STANDARDS. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> [APPLAUSE]

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS DAVID JOHNSON. I LIVE IN ZONE FOUR. RIGHT NEXT TO ALL SORTS OF POTENTIAL PROBLEMS. I DON'T WANT TO MAKE A RECOMMENDATION ONE WAY OR THE OTHER, BUT I DO WANT TO POINT OUT THE VAST MAJORITY OF THE CONVERSATION TODAY HAS BEEN ABOUT DEFENSIBLE SPACE. BUT HOME HARDENING IS A MUCH BIGGER, MUCH MORE EXPENSIVE, MUCH MORE COMPLICATED AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO PRODUCE PUSHBACK. SO I'M NOT QUITE SURE WHAT'S IN THE EMBER PROPOSAL ABOUT HOME HARDENING. BUT I ASK THE COUNCIL TO CONSIDER VERY CAREFULLY IF THERE ISN'T MUCH IN IT ABOUT HOME HARDENING TO DO SOMETHING ABOUT IT AND SECONDLY, TO INFORM US ABOUT THE BEST SCIENCE IN TERMS OF HOME HARDENING AND SO ON. BECAUSE I THINK THAT'S REALLY CRUCIAL. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. JUST A REMINDER TO EVERYONE, TURN OFF

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YOUR PHONES, PLEASE.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS MIA GOSHI, I'M A 40-PLUS YEAR RESIDENT OF BERKELEY. I WANT TO EXPRESS MY VERY STRONG SUPPORT OF THE EMBER PROPOSAL. WE LIVE SLIGHTLY OUTSIDE OF ZONE ZERO, BUT REALLY APPRECIATE THE WORK OF THE FIRE DEPARTMENT STAFF AND OTHERS IN THE CITY BECAUSE WE WANT OUR CITY TO BE SAFE AND PROTECTED. AND WE REALLY FEEL THAT THE SCIENCE SUPPORTS THE EMBER PROPOSAL. SO I JUST WANT TO SPEAK IN STRONG SUPPORT. BUT ALSO TO THANK THE STAFF FOR ALL OF THE HARD WORK THAT THE PROPOSAL REPRESENTS. THANK YOU SO MUCH. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. ARE THERE ANY OTHER IN-PERSON COMMENTS? IF NOT, WE WILL MOVE ONLINE.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. IF YOU ARE ON THE ZOOM AS AN ATTENDEE, PLEASE RAISE YOUR HAND TO PROVIDE PUBLIC COMMENT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IF YOU ARE ONLINE, JUST SO YOU KNOW, WE ARE DOING ONE-MINUTE COMMENTS.

>> CITY CLERK: YES, ONE MINUTE PER SPEAKER. WE CURRENTLY HAVE FIVE SPEAKERS IS RAISED HANDS. FIRST SPEAKER IS CHRIS CULLANDER.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS CHRIS CULL ANDER, I'M A RETIRED UCSF FACULTY MEMBER AND FIRE WISE COORDINATOR EXCEPT FOR OAKLAND AND BERKELEY. I'M ALSO A MEMBER OF THE BERKELEY FIRE SAFE COUNCIL BUT I'M SPEAKING FOR MYSELF TODAY. I'VE LIVED IN BERKELEY FOR OVER 40 YEARS AND WAS HERE FOR THE TUNNEL FIRE IN

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1991. I HAVE ATTENDED THE ZONE ZERO WORKSHOPS BY THE STATE BOARD OF FORESTRY AND FIRE PROTECTION AS WELL AS PRESENTATIONS ABOUT EMBER BY CHIEF SPRAGUE AND ARNOLD BY THE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT AND COUNCILMEMBER P BRENT BLACKABY AND READ ARTICLES ABOUT THE EMBER PROPOSAL ITSELF AND I'M CONVINCED THAT'S THE WAY TO GO. IN PUTTING IN ZONE ZERO WILL BE SADDENING AND EXPENSIVE BUT IT'S CLEARLY NECESSARY TO REDUCE THE RISK OF LOSING OUR HOMES AND ENDANGERING THE PROPERTIES AROUND US. THE MORE PEOPLE WHO DO THIS, THE FURTHER BERKELEY MOVES TOWARD BECOMING FIRE SAFE. I URGE THE CITY COUNCIL TO SUPPORT EMBER. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. NEXT SPEAKER IS RICK. RICK, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: RICK, ARE YOU THERE? WE MIGHT NEED TO CIRCLE BACK.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, NEXT, NANCY RADER.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MY NAME IS NANCY RADER, RESIDENT OF DISTRICT 6 AND MEMBER OF FIRE SAFE COUNCIL, I STRONGLY SUPPORT THE PROPOSAL INCLUDING EVENTUAL EXTENSION FURTHER DOWN THE HILL WHERE I LIVE. IN MY HOUSE WE BEGAN WORKING TO CREATE ZONE ZERO AFTER THE DEVASTATING TUBS FIRE IN 2017 WITH ENORMOUS RISK OF WILDFIRES BECAME UNDENIABLE. I TOOK DOWN A CLIMBING ROSE BUSH THAT WAS A MOTHER'S DAY GIFT AND REPLACED IT CERAMICS AND PUT

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DOWN CULTURAL PEBBLES. OUTSIDE ZONE ZERO I HAVE A GARDEN THAT ATTRACTS BEES AND BUTTERFLIES. THIS GIVES ME PEACE OF MIND AND THE COST WAS QUITE REASONABLE. BUT THIS IS A COLLECTIVE PROJECT, WE ALL HAVE TO ACT TO REDUCE THE RISK. THE EMBER PROPOSAL IS THE START OF THAT COLLECTIVE EFFORT AND I URGE YOU TO ADOPT IT TO HELP PROTECT THE ENTIRE CITY. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. WE CAN TRY RICK ONE MORE TIME. RICK, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. LAST CALL FOR RICK? ALL RIGHT. WE WILL GO TO CHERYL DAVILA, FORMER COUNCILMEMBER.

>> THANK YOU. SO, I UNDERSTAND ALL OF THIS IS GREAT FOR THE HILLS TO IMPLEMENT THESE STANDARDS. BUT WHAT ABOUT THE FLATS? WITH ALL THE, THERE'S NOT MUCH DEFENSIBLE SPACE WHEN YOU ARE PUTTING TWO OR THREE UNITS WITH DRIVEWAYS THAT DRIVE RIGHT UP TO THE BUILDING, IN BETWEEN THE BUILDING AND THE FENCE. IT'S LIKE WHY? I UNDERSTAND WHY DEFENSIBLE SPACE IS MORE -- WELL, MAYBE MORE HEAVILY NEEDED IN THE HILLS. BUT IT'S ALSO NEEDED IN THE FLATS. AND THEN WE ALSO HAVE ALL THESE OTHER THINGS THAT, LIKE BAYER AND OTHER COMPANIES WHO KNOWS WHAT IS IN THERE THAT IS FLAMMABLE, HIGHLY TOXIC.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS CHARLES SCAWTHORN.

>> THANK YOU VERY MUCH. HOPE YOU CAN HEAR ME. I LIVE IN CRESTON

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ROAD. I'M A RETIRED PROFESSOR OF NATURAL HAZARDS AND MITIGATION; I WORK IN FIRE DEPARTMENTS FROM LOS ANGELES TO VANCOUVER. THE COST IS GENERALLY REASONABLE, ALTHOUGH SINCE IT BENEFITS THE ENTIRE CITY SOME COST SUPPORT FOR THE RESIDENTS WHO HAVE TO TAKE THIS ACTION SHOULD BE CONSIDERED. THE POINT THAT THE FORMER SPEAKER MADE ABOUT TILDEN PARK AND PG&E ARE VERY IMPORTANT. THEY ARE THE SOURCE OF THE PROBLEM AND WE NEED TO GET THEM TO DO SOMETHING ABOUT IT. THE COMMENTS ABOUT THE FACT THAT THE RESEARCH IS UNCLEAR IS THE SAME ARGUMENT THAT'S ALWAYS USED BY THE TOBACCO INDUSTRY, NUCLEAR POWER, AND OTHERS AGAINST SOMETHING THAT IS CLEARLY BENEFICIAL. SO I DON'T THINK THAT'S A VERY STRONG ARGUMENT. AND LASTLY, DON'T LET PERFECT BE THE ENEMY OF THE GOOD. EMBER IS A VERY GOOD PROPOSAL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS SUSIE BAILEY.

>> MY NAME IS SUSAN BAILEY; I LIVE ON MUIR WAY WHICH IS A DIP AT THE TOP OF THE HILL. SO THAT THE WIND THAT COMES FROM THE NORTH ROARS DOWN OUR STREET, SLAMS AGAINST THE UPSTAIRS BEDROOM. IT IS VERY, VERY SCARY. AND I DON'T THINK THAT PEOPLE BELOW HAVE ANY IDEA JUST HOW VERY SCARY AND VERY HARD THE WIND IS. AND IT WILL BLOW EMBERS ALL OVER THE PLACE. I'M TOTALLY IN FAIR OF EMBER. I DO HOPE YOU WILL PASS IT. AND I THINK IT IS WORTH WHATEVER WE HAVE TO DO IN ORDER TO MAKE OUR HOUSE EVEN SAFER.

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>> CITY CLERK: THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS KELLY HAMMARGREN.

>> I LIVE IN THE FLATS AND I JUST WANT TO SAY THANK YOU TO THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND EVERYONE WHO CAME. I DON'T KNOW HOW YOUR EMAIL BOXES LOOK, BUT COUNTING TONIGHT, MY TABULATION IS ABOUT IT'S 2-TO-1 VOTING FOR THE EMBER PROGRAM. SO THANK YOU, EVERYONE, WHO IS IN SUPPORT OF THE PROGRAM. THAT'S IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, AND NEXT IS GIO. GIO, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> THANK YOU, I LIVE ON CRESTON ROAD IN THE VERY HIGH FIRE ZONE AND WHILE I VERY MUCH SUPPORT THE EMBER CONCEPT I OPPOSE A PART OF THE PROPOSED AMENDMENT TO THE FIRE CODE IN 19.48. IT MAKES CRIMINALS OUT OF BERKELEY RESIDENTS WHO CAN'T AFFORD TO MAKE THE CHANGES IN A THREE-YEAR PERIOD. MY NEIGHBORHOOD CONSISTS OF SENIORS WHO LIVE JUST ON SOCIAL SECURITY. WE SHOULDN'T HAVE TO FACE HEFTY FINES, LA LIENS ON OUR HOME FOR FAILING TO MAKE THE LARGER NUMBER OF CHANGES IN THREE YEARS, THAT'S WITH NO DEFINITIVE HELP TO PAY FOR THE CHANGES AND NO STREAMLINE PROCESSES FOR PERMITS NEEDED FOR HOME HARDENING MODIFICATIONS THAT WE OTHERWISE WOULD WANT TO MAKE. PLEASE VOTE NO ON THE ENFORCEMENT PROVISIONS. THERE ARE A LOT BETTER SOLUTIONS, THANK

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YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. NEXT IS MARY PAT.

>> HI, MY NAME IS MARY PAT FERAL, I'M A LONG TIME RESIDENT OF CRESTON ROAD AND ACTIVELY INVOLVED IN THE FIRE WISE COMMUNITY UP THERE NOW. I JUST WANT TO EXPRESS VERY STRONG SUPPORT FOR THE EMBER PROPOSAL. I THINK THE SCIENCE IS VERY SOUND. IF ANYTHING, I THINK IT'S NOT ENOUGH. I KNOW THAT, YOU KNOW, SOME OF THE SCIENCE SAYS IT SHOULD BE SEVEN FEET OR WHATEVER. BUT WHETHER IT'S SUFFICIENT IS QUESTIONABLE. WHETHER IT'S NECESSARY IS NOT. I THINK WE HAVE TO DO SOMETHING AND THIS IS A GREAT START. AND I WANT TO THANK ALL THE FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR COMING FORWARD WITH THIS GREAT PROPOSAL. THANK ALL THE FIRE-WISE COMMUNITIES ON THE RIDGE WHO ARE SUPPORTIVE AND REALLY, WE HAVE BEGUN OUR JOURNEY AT OUR HOUSE. IT'S PAINFUL. BUT AGAIN, NECESSARY. SO THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE FOUR MORE SPEAKERS. WE HAVE THEO GORDON IS NEXT. THEO?

>> HELLO, COUNCILMEMBERS. THANK YOU FOR TAKING THE TIME FOR THIS ISSUE. MY NAME IS THEO GORDON, I'M THE DISASTER AND FIRE COMMISSION VICE CHAIR, WE VOTED IN SUPPORT OF THIS MEASURE SO I WANTED TO REITERATE THAT SUPPORT. THIS SY IS A MEASURED AND SCIENCE-BASED APPROACH. HONESTLY, IT SUCKS AND IT'S HARD AND

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IT'S GOING TO REALLY TAKE A LOT OF WORK FROM THE COMMUNITY BUT IT'S ABSOLUTELY NECESSARY. SO AGAIN, I WANTED TO ASK YOU TO VOTE IN FAVOR OF THE PROPOSAL. I ALSO WANTED TO THANK THE FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR THIS PROPOSAL AND IN MY PERSONAL OPINION IS I'M GLAD TO SEE THE DEPARTMENT IS SHRINKING THE WEST SIDE OF THE OLD VERY HIGH FIRE ZONE BOUNDARY TO BE P MORE EVIDENCE BASED I THINK THAT SHOWS THE BALANCE THE FIRE DEPARTMENT STAFF HAS HIT WITH CRAFTING THIS LEGISLATION. I JUST WANT TO SAY THE FIRST THING I DID WHEN I MOVED TO BERKELEY, I BUILT A REDWOOD GARDEN BED. I LEARNED OF ALL THE RISKS. I'M NOT IN THE HIGH FIRE ZONE BUT I'M STILL GOING TO MOVE IT, THAT'S MY RESPONSIBILITY, IT'S ALL OF OUR RESPONSIBILITY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS ANDREW.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, COUNCILMEMBERS, MEMBERS OF THE FIRE DEPARTMENT, THANK YOU OBVIOUSLY FOR HOLDING THIS MEETING, IT'S UNFORTUNATE IT WASN'T HELD AT A TIME FOR PEOPLE WHO WORK IN PERSON TO APPEAR IN PERSON. WITHOUT ECHOING TOO MUCH OF THE COMMENTARY BY OTHERS, I STAND FIRMLY IN OPPOSITION TO THE PASSING AS WRITTEN. I THINK FUNDAMENTALLY THAT'S FOR TWO REASON. ONE I RECOGNIZE THE SHORT-TERM TERROR IN THE FACE OF THE SANTA ROSA FIRE AND PALISADES FIRES MOST RECENTLY. BUT I THINK LOOKING AT THIS SHORT-TERM SORT OF MYOPIC RESPONSE IS REALLY MUCH TO THE

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DETRIMENT OF THE GRANDER PROJECT WHICH I THINK HAVE TWO PRIMARY COMPONENTS THAT NEED REMEDIED. THE FIRST PG&E, THESE POWER LINES NEED TO BE PUT UNDERGROUND. THE SECOND, I'M SITTING AT MY HOUSE BELOW GRIZZLY PEAK, I CAN COUNT 42 EUCALYPTUS TREES. THE FAILURE TO SUBSIDIZE THE REMOVAL OF THESE TREES IS A TOTAL FAILURE OF PUBLIC POLICY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. I'M SORRY, THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS CHERYL DRINKWATER.

>> HI. MY NAME IS SHERYL DRINKWATER, I'M AN ARCHITECT IN BERKELEY AND ON THE BOARD OF -- COUNCIL. I SUPPORT THE WORK AND EMBER PROPOSAL. I ENCOURAGE RESIDENTS TO TALK TO YOUR NEIGHBORS ABOUT FORMING A FIRE WISE GROUP SO YOU CAN HELP EACH OTHER TAKE ACTION. HOMES WILL ALWAYS NEED TO BE MAINTAINED, PROTECT YOUR ASSET. YOU CAN WORK TO FIND GRANTS AND PROGRAMS TO ASSIST IN TAKING ACTION. THIS IS A DYNAMIC TIME AND THERE WILL BE MANY OPPORTUNITIES AS WE MOVE FORWARD. I ENCOURAGE YOU TO VOTE YES, CITY COUNCIL AND VISIT THE DIABLO FIRE SAFE COUNCIL WEBSITE TO LEARN MORE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE ONE MORE SPEAKER, GARY C. AND WE HAD ANOTHER ONE POP UP. OH, GARY C.

>> SORRY ABOUT THAT. REASON I'M SPEAKING NOW, I SUPPORT EMBER. I

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SENT ABOUT A MONTH AGO AN EMAIL TO THE CITY COUNCIL. THE REASON -- BUT I HAVEN'T HEARD ANYTHING TODAY ABOUT ONE OTHER ISSUE THAT DEALS WITH IMPLEMENTATION. THAT IS HAVING ENOUGH RESOURCES TO PERFORM THIS WORK. AS SOMEBODY WHO LIVES IN THE HILLS AND ELSEWHERE IN BERKELEY, IT'S HARD TO FIND ENOUGH PEOPLE TO DO THIS. THERE WERE PROBLEMS GETTING PEOPLE WITH THE GUTTER WORK AND THAT KIND OF STUFF. IT'S HARD TO BELIEVE THIS COULD BE DONE IN A VERY QUICK FASHION. SO I WANT TO JUST MENTION THAT SO EVERYBODY COULD HEAR IT. BECAUSE IT'S GOING TO BE AN ISSUE IN THE FUTURE IF YOU ARE GOING TO CITE PEOPLE, YOU HAVE TO GIVE THEM ENOUGH TIME OR PROVIDE RESOURCES OR HELPING PEOPLE GET THIS WORK. OKAY, THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: THANK YOU. NEXT IS MATTHEW KATSAROS.

>> HEY, COUNCILMEMBERS. THIS IS MATT. I'M A RESIDENT OF PANORAMIC HILL. AND I'M LOOSELY IN SUPPORT OF WHAT YOU ARE TALKING ABOUT BUT I THINK I WANT TO ECHO WHAT OTHERS HAVE SAID. WHEN WE ARE TALKING ABOUT CALIFORNIA WILDFIRES, I DON'T UNDERSTAND HOW WE ARE NOT TALKING ABOUT BRINGING THESE POWER LINES UNDERGROUND. T IS THE ONE THING THAT SEEMS TO BE STARTING EVERY SINGLE ONE OF THESE WILDFIRES. AND SO AS WE TALK ABOUT ALL THESE RESIDENTS TRYING TO DO THEIR PART TO HARDEN OUR HOMES, ALL OF US ARE VERY MUCH IN SUPPORT OF BRINGING THESE POWER LINES

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UNDERGROUND. SO I WOULD LIKE TO HEAR PEOPLE TALK A LITTLE BIT ABOUT WHAT THE PLAN IS FOR THAT.

>> CITY CLERK: THANK YOU. IF YOU ARE ON A ZOOM, ON A TELEPHONE LINE, YOU WOULD PRESS *9 TO RAISE YOUR HAND. WE HAVE ONE MORE SPEAKER HERE. JESSAMYN HISE.

>> HI EVERYONE, I WORK FOR FIRE SAFE COUNCIL IN A NEIGHBORING COUNTY, AND I UNDERSTAND EVERYONE'S COMPLAINTS AND CONCERNS AND I ALSO NEED TO ECHO SUPPORT FOR THE EMBER INITIATIVE AND REMIND PEOPLE THAT CALIFORNIA HAS EXPERIENCED WILDFIRE BEFORE PG&E AND BEFORE THE INVASIVE SPECIES LIKE EUCALYPTUS CAME TO OUR LAND. WE HAVE TO LEARN TO ADAPT TO WILDFIRE. SO I JUST WANTED TO MAKE SURE THAT WAS SAID. BECAUSE FIRE IS NOT GOING AWAY, NO MATTER IF WE UNDERGROUND ALL THE LINES OR DO ALL THE HOME HARDENING, WE ARE STILL GOING TO HAVE FIRE WE ARE GOING TO HAVE TO LIVE WITH. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, THAT'S THE LAST ONLINE COMMENTER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. THANK YOU VERY MUCH. WE ARE GOING TO START NOW WITH COUNCIL COMMENTS AND QUESTIONS WITH COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY.

>> B. BLACKABY: GREAT, THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. BEFORE -- I'VE GOT SOME REMARKS. AND BEFORE I DO, I DON'T KNOW, CHIEF, IF YOU WANT TO RESPOND TO ANY OF THE COMMENTS, JUST GIVE YOU AN

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OPPORTUNITY TO ANSWER A FEW OF THE QUESTIONS, IF YOU HAVE ANYTHING YOU WANT TO SAY, I HAVE A FEW QUESTIONS AND THEN SOME REMARKS.

>> SURE, THANK YOU. I WILL TRY TO HIT SOME OF THE BIGGEST ONES. INSURANCE COSTS, INSURANCE SKYROCKET K, THE ABILITY TO NOT BE IN THE FAIR PLAN AND HAVE A NORMAL INSURANCE THAT PROPERLY PROVIDES COVERAGE FOR THE HOME. WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING IS IN ALIGNMENT WITH CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE, IBHS, THE NONPROFIT THAT IS FUNDED LARGELY BY THE INSURANCE INDUSTRY. SO IF ANYTHING, WHAT WE ARE DOING NOW IS COMPLETELY OUT OF ALIGNMENT. WE ISSUE A CERTIFICATION OF COMPLIANCE AND IN REALITY THAT DOES NOT A LIE WITH THE INSURERS OR DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE. SO THIS WOULD, HOPEFULLY, LOWER INSURANCE RATES AND CREATE NEIGHBORHOODS THAT ARE MITIGATED THAT ARE MORE ATTRACTIVE FOR INSURANCE COMPANIES TO RETURN TO THE MARKET. FINANCIAL HELP, COST OF DOING THE WORK. THROUGH THE PILOT PROGRAM WE DID, WE KNOW THE AVERAGE COST OF PERFORMING DEFENSIBLE SPACE WORK ON A PROPERTY, OUT TO 100 FEET IS $2900 PER PARCEL. THAT'S REMOVAL ONLY. WE HAVE THAT DATA. THAT'S FOR PARCELS IN THE HILLS BETWEEN WILDCAT CANYON AND GRIZZLY PEAK. WE HAVE A $1 MILLION CALFIRE GRANT GOING TOWARD THIS PURPOSE. WE WILL BE APPLYING FOR ADDITIONAL GRANTS. WE HAVE FUNDS THROUGH MEASURE FF TO SUBSIDIZE THIS WORK FOR THOSE WHO QUALIFY. INCOME, OVER 65, INCAPACITY TO DO THE WORK ARE OTHER

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WAYS TO QUALIFY. TILDEN PARK. THOSE ARE WORTHWHILE, WE TRIED TO GET $50 MILLION IN MEASURE L FOR UNDERGROUNDING. IT DIDN'T PASS. IT'S AN EXPENSIVE MEASURE, CPUC HAS MADE IT MORE DIFFICULT. OUR ADMISSIONS COST FROM POWER LINES, ABSOLUTELY. DO WE WANT TO UNDERGROUND THEM? ABSOLUTELY. DO WE HAVE CONTROL? NO. FIRE MOVED THROUGH THE LANDSCAPE EVERY 5-7 YEARS. GRASS FIRES CAN DO THE SAME DAMAGE AS YOU SAW ON THE VIDEO FROM TEXAS AS A FIRE WITH TALLER VEGETATION. SO WE REMOVE THE EUCS. GET THE FIRE OUT OF THE HILLS. UNDERGROUND, FIRES CAN STILL IGNITE. THE MAP ORDINANCE CONFLICT, WE FIXED THAT IN THE SUPPLEMENTAL. THE MAP IS NOT OFFICIAL, IT'S A REFERENCE-ONLY. BUT IT DOES NOW FOLLOW THE PARCEL LINES ON THE WEST SIDE OF THE STREETS. ADJACENT HOMES PROVIDING DEFENSIBLE SPACE WHEN THERE IS NOT FIVE FEET OF SPACE ON A PARCEL, THERE'S A PROVISION IN THE FIRE CODE THAT ALLOWS US TO DIRECT RESIDENTS TO CREATE DEFENSIBLE SPACE IN RECOGNITION OF STRUCTURES ON ADJACENT STRUCTURES. FENCES. FENCES ARE A HUGE ISSUE, AS YOU SAW IN THE VIDEO. THEY ARE A PRIMARY SPREADER OF FIRE IN NEIGHBORHOODS FROM HOME TO HOME. BUT WE RECOGNIZE THERE'S A HUGE COST ASSOCIATED WITH THIS. EXISTING FENCES THAT ARE WITHIN FIVE FEET RUNNING PARALLEL TO HOMES AREN'T GOING TO BE REQUIRED TO BE TAKEN OUT, WE STILL RECOMMEND IT BECAUSE IT'S A PRIMARY THREAT. NOT REQUIRED TO BE TAKEN OUT, BUT YOU CAN'T BUILD NEW FENCES WITHIN FIVE FEET THAT ARE PARALLEL TO A

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STRUCTURE. FENCES OR GATES THAT CONNECT TO A HOME, THOSE DO NEED TO BE REPLACED, JUST THE FIRST FIVE FEET. YOU CAN REMOVE IT AND THAT BRINGS YOU INTO COMPLIANCE OR YOU CAN REPLACE IT. REMOVING CARS, SO FIRE TRUCKS CAN GET THROUGH, ABSOLUTELY. THAT'S ANOTHER COMPONENT OF THE EMBER PROPOSAL WE ARE COMING BACK TO THE COUNCIL WITH IN PROBABLY MAY. AND MAYBE IT'S ODD FOR A FIRE CHIEF TO SAY THIS. FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES ARE IMPORTANT, BUT THEY ARE JUST A PIECE OF THIS PUZZLE. IF WE DON'T DO THIS WORK, NO AMOUNT OF FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES ARE GOING TO STOP THESE FIRES. L.A., LOS ANGELES HAS ONE OF THE BIGGEST DENSEST ACCUMULATION OF FIRE DEPARTMENTS, ENGINES, IT'S NOT ABOUT HOW MANY THERE ARE. THAT'S A PIECE OF THE PUZZLE, NOT THE ENTIRE ANSWER. WE NEED TO DO MORE RESEARCH; THERE'S A LOT OF CHALLENGES ABOUT ENFORCING THINGS RETROACTIVELY IN THE BUILDING CODE. IT'S VERY EXPENSIVE, THERE'S NO STATE OR FEDERAL MONEY AVAILABLE FOR THAT. SO WE NEED TO TAKE A MEASURED APPROACH. WE KNOW RETROFITTING VENTS; SCREENING GUTTERS AND OTHER LOW-COST BASIC HOME HARDENING MEASURES CAN MAKE A BIG DIFFERENCE. WE ARE INCENTIVIZING THOSE, PROVIDING MATERIALS TO DO THAT WORK AND WE WILL BE PURSUING GRANTS AND OTHER INITIATIVES TO SUPPORT HOMEOWNERS WHEN WE DO BRING A PROPOSAL FORWARD. I THINK THAT COVERS IT.

>> B. BLACKABY: YEAH, THANKS. ANOTHER ONE, THIS QUESTION ABOUT

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NO VEGETATION, VERSUS WHAT ABOUT THE SUCCULENTS, WHAT ABOUT THE CAMELLIAS. I WOULD LOVE FOR YOU TO RESPOND TO THAT AND WHY IT IS SO IMPORTANT TO HAVE THAT FIVE FEET OF CLEARANCE.

>> THE FIVE FEET OF CLEARANCE IS BASED ON PRIMARILY LAB TESTING AND EXPERIMENTATION. THERE ARE NO MITIGATED COMMUNITY THAT'S HAVE UNDERTAKEN WHAT WE ARE PROPOSING TODAY THAT HAVE BEEN AFFECTED BY FIRE, THERE'S NO POST-INCIDENT ANALYSIS. THERE'S SEVERAL REASONS THOSE PLANTS AREN'T ALLOWED IN THE FIVE FEET. WHILE THEY DO REQUIRE MAINTENANCE TO MAINTAIN THEIR RESISTANT QUALITIES, THEY CAN GROW BEYOND SIZE, MATERIAL DROPS AND IGNITES EMBERS. THIS IS TRUE OF SUCCULENTS THAT HAVE HIGHER WATER CONTENT. THEY CAN TRAP LONE LEAVES AND NEEDLES IN HIGH WIND EVENTS, THIS OCCURRED IN 1993 AND '91. THE INSURANCE WILDFIRE STANDARD, ONE OF THE PUBLIC COMMENTS DOESN'T ALLOW PLANT OF ANY SPECIES IN ZONE ZERO. THE CHIEF'S POINT IF WE ARE GOING TO BE CONSISTENT WITH THE CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE AND THAT DESIGNATION, IT'S IMPORTANT TO MAINTAIN WITH THAT. AND THE PRESENT DRAFT OF THE CALIFORNIA BORDER FORESTRY REGULATIONS ARE LIKELY NOT TO INCLUDE EXCEPTIONS FOR FIRE RESISTANT PLANT SPECIES.

>> B. BLACKABY: GREAT. THANK YOU. I PREPARED SOME REMARKS. I FELT LIKE SINCE YOU BROUGHT SLIDES I NEED TO BRING A FEW SLIDES, SO LET ME SHARE A COUPLE OF THINGS JUST TO KIND OF HELP GUIDE

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THE DISCUSSION HERE. I WOULD LIKE TO THANK EVERYONE WHO CAME TODAY TO SHARE AND PARTICIPATE IN THIS DISCUSSION. IN PARTICULAR, TO CHIEF SPRAGUE, ASSISTANT CHIEF ARNOLD, CHIEF WHITE, EVERYONE WHO WORKED TOGETHER TO PULL TOGETHER THIS TRULY COMPREHENSIVE PLAN. THANK YOU FOR YOUR LEADERSHIP. THIS TRULY WAS A B.F.D. IN ALL RESPECTS. TO MY PREDECESSOR, SUSAN WENGRAF, WHO HAS BEEN A CHAMPION FOR FIRE SAFETY FOR MANY YEARS, SHE ISN'T HERE BUT I'M SURE SHE IS WATCHING ONLINE. SHE HELPED US GET TO THIS POINT TODAY. WE CAN'T THANK HER ENOUGH. I'M TAKING THE BATON AND CONTINUING THE RACE AS MANY OF US ARE. IT WAS REALLY HER IN CONJUNCTION WITH THE DEPARTMENT. NO MATTER WHAT SIDE YOU ARE ON, IN PERSON OR ON ZOOM AND SENT SOME OF THE DOZENS, IF NOT HUNDREDS OF EMAILS WE ALL RECEIVED, THANK YOU. I CAN TELL YOU THAT I READ EVERY EMAIL. MY OFFICE AND I ARE STILL RESPONDING TO MANY OF THEM, BUT I REALLY DO APPRECIATE THE ENGAGEMENT AS WE DELIBERATE TODAY BECAUSE IT'S TRULY BEEN BERKELEY AT ITS BEST. NOW TO KIND OF WALK THROUGH SOME COMMENTS. IF I COULD ADVANCE THIS HERE. WE KNOW THIS IS A BIG ASK. IT'S BEEN SAID BEFORE. IT'S BEEN SAID MANY TIMES TONIGHT. CLEARING FIVE FEET OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE AROUND YOUR HOME, INVESTING IN HOME HARDENING, A LITTLE BIT OR A LOT, WORKING, COLLABORATING WITH YOUR NEIGHBORS, PUSHING US OUT OF OUR COMFORT ZONES, WHAT WE DO IN OUR DAY-TO-DAY ACTIVITIES. DOING THIS ACROSS A THOUSAND

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HOMES TO START AND MAYBE SEVERAL HOMES AHEAD. IT IS A BIG ASK. BUT THE WILDFIRE RISK TO BERKELEY ALSO PRESENTS A BIG EXISTENTIAL THREAT TO OUR COMMUNITY. WE CAN'T SOLVE IT WITH A SMALL PARTIAL SOLUTION. WHICH LEADS ME TO THE NEXT POINT. AGAIN WE HAVE HEARD SOME OF THIS AS WELL. IT'S GOING TO REQUIRE BIG COLLECTIVE ACTION TO MEET THE MOMENT. AND I'M CONFIDENT THAT WE CAN. BECAUSE BERKELEY DOES DO BIG THINGS. AS MY COLLEAGUE, COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE OFTEN SAYS, BERKELEY PUNCHES ABOVE IT'S WEIGHT. WE LEAD THE WAY; THIS IS JUST ONE MORE OPPORTUNITY TO PROVIDE THAT LEADERSHIP. IN MANY RESPECTS THIS IS ALSO THE ANSWER TO THE COLLECTIVE HELPLESSNESS WE ALL SEE AFTER WE SEE WILDFIRE THAT'S AFFECT COMMUNITIES JUST LIKE OURS ACROSS THE STATE. THIS IS SOMETHING WE CAN DO. IT'S THE SINGLE BIGGEST AND PERHAPS ONLY EFFECTIVE THING WE CAN DO TO TAKE CONTROL AND WE KNOW THE STATE IS COMING DOWN WITH THESE REQUIREMENTS ANYWAY IN A MATTER OF YEARS. AS A COUNCILMEMBER THAT REPRESENTS THIS DISTRICT, I'M NOT COMFORTABLE ON ROLLING THE DICE ON FIVE MORE YEARS OF RISK BEFORE WE DO SOMETHING. IT'S TIME TO ACT. LET'S ACT NOW TOGETHER. AS MICHEL AND OTHERS HAVE MENTIONED THIS IS A PHOTO, FROM THE PAST WEEKEND. MORE THAN 100 VOLUNTEERS THAT CAME OUT TO JOIN WITH NEIGHBORS ON CRESTON AND GRIZZLY PEAK TO CUT DOWN AND HAUL OUT DEBRIS AREAS THAT WERE OVERGROWN. THIS IS ORGANIZED BY A LOCAL FIRE WISE COMMUNITY TAKING INITIATIVE TO

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PROTECT THEIR NEIGHBORHOOD ON THEIR OWN. I WANT TO THANK MICHEL AND ERIK AND SARAH AND EVERYONE. THIS IS THE KIND OF WORK WE NEED TO DO TOGETHER. CHANGE IS HARD. IT'S GOING TO TAKE TIME. WE NOWELL. KNOW. WE AREN'T GOING TO SOLVE THIS IN A WEEK, MONTH OR EVEN A YEAR, BUT WE HAVE TO GET STARTED. THE HARDEST PART IS TAKING THE FIRST STEP AND THIS IS THE FIRST STEP. THAT'S WHAT WE ARE ASKING YOU TO DO TODAY, THEN IT'S UP TO ALL OF US TO KEEP GOING TO DELIVER ON THE PROMISE THAT WE ARE PLEDGING TO EACH OTHER TODAY. THIS IS JUST THE BEGINNING AND WE HAVE A LOT OF WORK TO DO. THAT'S WHY FROM HERE ON OUT, MY WHOLE FOCUS IS GOING TO SHIFT TO HOW DO WE MAKE IT EASIER. WE HAVE HEARD QUESTIONS; CONCERNS AND THEY ARE ALL VALID HOW WE DO THAT. THE NUMBER ONE IS FINANCING FUNDING INCENTIVES. THE CHIEF ALREADY MENTIONED WE HAVE SECURED A $1 MILLION CALFIRE GRANT. WE KNOW THE STATE PASSED PROP 4 LAST FALL WITH PROMISES OF TENS OF MILLIONS OF WILDFIRE RESILIENCE FUNDING. WE NEED TO ACCESS MORE OF THAT FUNDING. WE ARE LOOKING AT LOW-INTEREST LOANS, ARE THERE SOME TAX CREDIT, EVEN A TIGHT BUDGET ENVIRONMENT, AND THE CITY MANAGER DOESN'T WANT TO HEAR ME SAY THIS, BUT ARE THERE OTHER TAX CREDITS OR OTHER VEHICLES WE CAN PURSUE TO HELP REDUCE THE BURDEN JUST A LITTLE BIT. AGAIN, PASSING THE POLICY IS ONE THING. MAKING IT HAPPEN AND IMPLEMENTING IT IS QUITE ANOTHER. AND I AM COMPLETELY ONBOARD, 100% THAT FINANCING IS A BIG PART

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OF THAT. SO WE NEED TO ADDRESS THAT. BEYOND THAT, EDUCATION, COMMUNICATION, THROUGH MAIL, ONLINE, PERSON TO PERSON, DOOR TO DOOR, IMPLEMENTATION, WORKSHOPS, TRAININGS, THERE ARE SO MANY THINGS IN THIS CHANGE MANAGEMENT WE NEED TO DO HERE TO BRING PEOPLE ALONG AND SHOW PEOPLE THE PATH. WE HAVE ALREADY GOT SOME GREAT MODEL HOMES IN THE YARDS. PEOPLE HAVE DONE ZONE ZERO IN DISTRICT 6 SHOWING WHAT IS POSSIBLE. THIS DOESN'T HAVE TO BE SOMETHING THAT IS SCARY OR UGLY. THERE ARE ALREADY PEOPLE WHO HAVE DONE THIS WORK AND CAN SHOW US THE WAY. I THINK THIS IS ALL PART OF THAT WORK. AND THE VOLUNTEER MOBILIZATIONS LIKE WE SAW IN CRESTON LAST WEEKEND. ANOTHER THING THAT WE HEARD THAT IS IMPORTANT TO ME IS THE SENSE THAT AGAIN, NONE OF US ARE IN THIS ALONE, RIGHT? WE KNOW THAT COLLECTIVE ACTION IS WHAT IS REQUIRED HERE. WE HAVE TO MOBILIZE AN ALL OF CITY AND REGION RESPONSE TO THIS PROBLEM. BECAUSE IT'S COMPLICATED. WHILE WE ARE DOING OUR PART IT'S ONE OF MANY PARTS THAT NEEDS TO BE DONE, AS WE HAVE TALKED ABOUT. JUST TO TALK A LITTLE BIT ABOUT ALL THE REGIONAL PARTNERS THAT HAVE A PIECE OF THIS, WE TALKED ABOUT THIS FROM BERKELEY LAB, THROUGH CERTAINLY THE PARK DISTRICT IN TILDEN PARK, PG&E, U.C. BERKELEY, AND THE LAND THEY MAINTAIN. EAST BAY MUNICIPAL UTILITY DISTRICT. EAST BAY. THEY HAVE ALREADY PLEDGED AND DOING WORK, BUT CAN THEY DO MORE? ABSOLUTELY. SHOULD THEY DO MORE? ABSOLUTELY. THAT'S OUR RESPONSIBILITY AS ELECTED OFFICIALS

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IS TO KEEP EVERYONE'S FEET TO THE FIRE, NO PUN INTENDED BUT EVERYONE HAS GOT TO DO THEIR PART. WE HAVE TO REDUCE AND REMOVE MORE EUCALYPTUS, ABSOLUTELY. SO ALL OF THESE THINGS ARE IMPORTANT. I WILL ALSO SAY WE HAVE GREAT PARTNERS, ELECTED OFFICIALS AT THE STATE AND FEDERAL LEVEL. A FEW WEEKS AGO THAT WAS CHIEF SPRAGUE DRIVING THE BUS, A REALLY GOOD DRIVER. BUT WE IN A NAVIGATED, WITH THE MAYOR, WE TOOK ASSEMBLY MEMBER WICKS AROUND THIS AREA. CONCERNS ABOUT ADDING MORE HOUSING DENSITY IN THE HILLS WE WERE UP FRONT. SENATOR ARREGUIN IS IN THE MIDDLE, THE VERY FIRST THING HE CALLED OUT IN HIS INAUGURATION SWEARING IN REMARKS WAS THE FACT THAT WILDFIRE FUNDING AND RESILIENCY WAS AN IMPORTANT PRIORITY FOR HIM. WE WILL MAKE SURE THAT IS TRUE. WE ARE ALREADY HAVING CONVERSATIONS ABOUT THINGS. HE SITS ON THE PUBLIC SAFETY COMMITTEE, ASKING HOW DO WE HOLD PG&E MORE ACCOUNTABLE; UNDERGROUNDING IS AN IMPORTANT ASK. SENATOR SCHIFF'S FIRST BILL IS A FEDERAL TAX CREDIT FOR HARDENING HOMES, RIGHT? LOTS OF PEOPLE ARE WORKING ON THIS. WE HAVE LOTS OF GREAT PARTNERS AND AGAIN IT'S UP TO US TO COORDINATE AND KEEP PUSHING BECAUSE THEY ARE PART OF THIS SOLUTION AS WELL. A LITTLE BIT MORE JUST ON THE SORT OF COMBINING OF HOME HARDENING DEFENSIBLE SPACE. THESE ARE A FEW EXAMPLES OF HOMES ALREADY IN THE HILLS. SOME EXAMPLES, SOME OF THESE PEOPLE WILL RECOGNIZE THESE HOMES BECAUSE IT MIGHT BE THERE'S. PEOPLE THERE IN THE AUDIENCE. BUT

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AGAIN, YOU CAN BLEND AND DO THIS WORK IN THE LANDSCAPE OF THE HILLS. LOTS OF GREAT VEGETATION WE CAN MAINTAIN. WHILE ALSO DOING THE FIVE FEET OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE AROUND THE HOME. WE CAN DO IT, RIGHT? AND IN THE PROCESS IT GIVES OUR FIREFIGHTERS THE BEST CHANCE TO HOLD THE LINE. A LOT OF WHAT WE ARE DOING HERE IS SLOWING THE FIRE, PREVENTING AN EMBER STORM FROM IGNITING INTO A STRUCTURE-TO STRUCTURE, AND JUST GIVING THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND OUR COLLEAGUES TIME TO HOLD THE LINE. WE CAN DO IT. I THINK THERE'S BEEN SOME MISCONCEPTION FROM SOMEWHAT THAT FIVE FEET OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE IS FOR. I HAVE HEARD SOME PEOPLE RAISE A CONCERN THAT HEY, LOOK, IN A WALL OF FLAMES THAT COMES OVER THE RIDGE AND HEADS TO MY HOUSE, WHAT I DO IN THAT FIVE FOOT OF SPACE DOESN'T MATTER. THAT'S PROBABLY TRUE, IF THE WALL OF FLAMES IS COMING OVER THE HOUSE. BUT WHAT WE ARE TALKING ABOUT HERE IS HOW DO WE PREVENT THE EMBER STORM FROM METASTASIZING, RIGHT? HOW DO WE STOP THE EMBERS FLYING AT TILDEN PARK FROM IGNITING THE HOMES ALL ALONG THAT BORDER? THAT'S REALLY WHERE THE DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HOME HARDENING COME INTO PLAY. I THINK THAT'S AN IMPORTANT MENTAL MODEL FOR FOLKS. THINKING ABOUT WHAT AND WHY WE ARE DOING THIS. IT'S BECAUSE WE DON'T WANT THAT STRUCTURE-TO-STRUCTURE TO START IN THE FIRST PLACE. ONCE WE GET TO THAT POINT WE ARE IN A WORLD OF HURT. OUR FIREFIGHTERS CAN HANDLE MAYBE TWO OR THREE HOMES ON FIRE IF WE LIMIT OUR

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EXPOSURE. BUT IT WILL BE IMPOSSIBLE TO HANDLE 200-300 HOMES ON FIRE. THAT'S WHAT WE ARE TRYING TO IMPEDE. A COUPLE LAST THINGS AND I WILL WRAP UP. I JUST WANT TO SAY I HAVE HEARD AND WE HEARD TONIGHT A NUMBER OF VERY REAL CONCERNS AND I HONOR THEM. THESE FEELINGS ARE REAL, EMOTIONS ARE REAL, THE INVESTMENT OF TIME PEOPLE HAVE MADE IN THEIR PROPERTIES ARE REAL. WE HAVE TO FIGURE OUT HOW TO MOVE THROUGH THOSE CONCERNS AND ACTUALLY MAKE PROGRESS. PEOPLE WHO ARE BEING ASKED TO RIP OUT THEIR BEAUTIFUL 50-YEAR-OLD WYSTERIA PLANTS, IT'S PAINFUL. BUT SCIENCE SHOWS THESE ARE THE STEPS WE NEED TO DEFEND THAT FIVE FEET OF SPACE AND STOP THAT EMBER STORM FROM IGNITING STRUCTURES. WE HEARD CONCERNS ABOUT COST, INCOME, LIMITATIONS ON THE ABILITY TO FINANCE THIS. AS WE MENTIONED, 100%, WE NEED TO ADDRESS THAT. THAT'S WHAT WE HAVE TO DO IN THE NEXT 3-6 MONTHS IS SOLVING THAT PROBLEM TO MAKE THE IMPLEMENTATION MORE POSSIBLE. THAT WILL BE MY PRIMARY FOCUS ON THE COUNCIL OVER THE NEXT SIX MONTHS IS HOW DO WE MAKE THE FINANCING POSSIBLE? BECAUSE AGAIN, DOING THIS AND HELPING HOMEOWNERS FINANCE IS GOOD FOR THEM. IT'S GOOD FOR THE NEIGHBORHOOD. BUT IT'S ALSO A PUBLIC GOOD FOR ALL OF BERKELEY, RIGHT? THIS IS SOMETHING ABOUT PROTECTING THE NEIGHBORHOODS. THE CHIEF MENTIONED AND TALKED ABOUT INSURANCE BEFORE. PEOPLE ARE CONCERNED THAT BY CALLING OUT THE MAPS IN THIS WAY, OR IDENTIFYING THE ZONE IN THIS WAY, WE WILL MAKE INSURANCE MORE

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EXPENSIVE OR DIFFICULT TO GET. AND I WOULD JUST SAY RESPECTFULLY, I THINK THE OPPOSITE IS TRUE. THAT THE FACT IS PEOPLE ARE ALREADY LOSING THEIR INSURANCE IN THE HILLS. PEOPLE ARE ALREADY FACING SIGNIFICANT PREMIUM INCREASES IN THE HILLS AND DOING NOTHING IS NOT GOING TO ADDRESS THAT PROBLEM. WHAT WE ARE DOING IS WORKING TO EASE THAT BURDEN OVER TIME. AGAIN, I HAVE CONCERN ABOUT INSURANCE. WE HAVE BEEN TALKING TO FOLKS IN THE INSURANCE COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE. WE NEED TO CLOSE THE LOOP TO MAKE IT REAL, IF YOU DO THIS WORK YOU SHOULD BE GUARANTEED INSURANCE OR DISCOUNTS AND MAKE SURE THAT HAPPENS ON THE POLICY SIDE. ON THE EVACUATION FRONT, I'M PLEASED THE COUNCIL PASSED OUR SAFE PASSAGES ITEM A FEW WEEKS AGO. INCREASING THE NUMBER OF RED CURBS, NO PARKING ZONES AND ENFORCEMENT ESPECIALLY DURING RED FLAG DAYS. WE KNOW EVACUATION IS IMPORTANT, BUT AS THE CHIEF AND ASSISTANT CHIEF TOLD US, EVACUATION SHOULD BE OUR CHIEF STRATEGY. EVEN IF WE OPEN UP ALL THE STREETS AND MAXIMIZE THE INGRESS AND EGRESS, WE STILL HAVE MORE PEOPLE IN THE HILLS WE CAN SAFELY EVACUATE IN A MATTER OF MINUTES SO EVACUATION IS STILL PART OF THE STRATEGY. UNDERGROUNDING, EUCALYPTUS REMOVAL, 100%, WE SHOULD DO ALL OF THAT. BUT I ASK WHAT IF WE UNDERGROUNDED EVERY POWER LINE, AND WHAT IF WE REMOVED EVERY EUCALYPTUS TREE AND A FIRE STILL STARTED IN THE PARK? WHAT DO WE DO? THAT'S, TO ME, WHY EMBER IS SO IMPORTANT. WE NEED TO ACT

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ALONG ALL THESE DIFFERENT DIMENSIONS. WE NEED TO PREVENT THE LIKELIHOOD A FIRE STARTS AND MAKE SURE WE ARE MAXIMUM DEFENSIVE POSITION TO CONTAIN IT BY ALL THE WORK WE ARE DOING AROUND THE HOMES. I THINK ALL THESE PIECES WORK TOGETHER. WE CAN'T PUT OUR EGGS IN ANYONE BASKET OR ANOTHER, WE NEED TO DO ALL THESE THINGS TO MAXIMIZE THE CHANCES OF SUCCESS. ONE LAST THING I HEAR IS PEOPLE WHO ARE CONCERNED THIS IS GOING TO FUNDAMENTALLY CHANGE THE CHARACTER AND NATURE OF LIVING HERE. AND AGAIN, I UNDERSTAND. BUT I DON'T THINK IT HAS TO. IT'S WHY WE ARE MOST FOCUSED ON THE FIRST FIVE FEET AROUND YOUR HOME AND ENCOURAGING NEIGHBORS TO CONTINUE CULTIVATING THE WELL-MAINTAINED LANDSCAPES AND GARDENS FIVE FEET BEYOND THAT DISTANCE. THE MAIN CONCERN IS FIVE FEET AND STOPPING AN EMBER STORM FROM IGNITING A HOME. IF WE DO THIS WORK IT WILL ALLOW US TO WAKE UP ON THOSE AUGUST DAYS AND BE A LITTLE LESS AFRAID WHAT MAY BE COMING. WE ARE BUILDING A FIRE-SAFE BERKELEY TOGETHER THAT ALLOWS US TO CONTINUE LIVING IN THIS BEAUTIFUL PLACE IN A MORE SUSTAINABLE BALANCED WAY. I'M PROUD TO SUPPORT EMBER. I'M PROUD OF ALL OF THE WORK THAT'S GONE INTO THE PROPOSAL. I'M NOT EXCITED OR THRILLED WE HAVE TO DO IT BUT I'M CONVINCED IT'S NECESSARY, IT'S IMPORTANT AND IT WILL MAKE A DIFFERENCE. I TRUST THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND EXPERTS THEY HAVE WORKED WITH TO CONSTRUCT A COMPREHENSIVE PLAN TO MAKE US MORE WILDFIRE RESILIENT. THESE ARE SMART FOLKS AS WE HAVE SEEN

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TODAY, THEY ARE DATA-DRIVEN. AS WE LEARN MORE AND THE SCIENCE EVOLVES I'M CONFIDENT THEY WILL BE GUIDED BY THAT AND WE WILL CONTINUE TO IMPROVE THIS PLAN. I'M SURE WHAT WE ARE STARTING WITH IS NOT PERFECT, WE WILL CONTINUE TO MAKE UPDATES AS WE LEARN MORE BUT WAITING UNTIL A PERFECT PLAN IS NOT AN P OUN SH. I DON'T WANT TO BE THE SHOULDER THAT RESIDENTS CRY ON AFTER WE HAVE LOST OUR NEIGHBORHOODS IN A WILDFIRE, I WANT TO BE PART OF THE LEADERSHIP IN THIS CITY THAT KEPT BERKELEY ON THE PATH TO WILDFIRE RESILIENCE. THAT'S WHY I'M PROUD TO SUPPORT EMBER TODAY. WHILE I KNOW MANY OF MY COLLEAGUES WILL SPEAK, I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO ADOPT THE STAFF RECOMMENDATION TO PASS BOTH ITEMS ONE AND TWO ON THE FIRE MAP AND ADOPT AMENDMENTS TO THE BERKELEY FIRE CODE.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: SECOND.

>> B. BLACKABY: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU SO MUCH. THAT WAS A TOUGH ACT TO FOLLOW. BUT I HAVE A COUPLE QUESTIONS, FIRST THANK YOU FOR THE WORK YOU PUT INTO THIS AND I'M ALSO REALLY EXCITED TO SUPPORT IT. I HAVE A COUPLE QUESTIONS. FIRST ABOUT PIEDMONT AVENUE. IN ITEM 1 UNDER A HIGH FIRE SEVERITY FROM PIEDMONT TO BANCROFT BUT ALSO IDENTIFIED AS A HIGH FIRE SEVERITY ZONE. IN THIS UPDATED FROM STADIUM WAY TO DWIGHT WAY, I'M CURIOUS ABOUT THAT

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REPETITION.

>> CORRECT. IT'S A LITTLE CONFUSING. THE HIGH AREA IS IDENTIFIED FROM THAT VERY WESTERN BOUNDARY AND AREAS OF HIGH TO THE VERY HIGH. THE DEFINITION OF HIGH IN THE FIRE CODE SAYS ALL AREAS OF THIS ZONE EXCLUDING PANORAMIC AND GRIZZLY PEAK. DOES THAT MAKE SENSE?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YEAH, IN TERMS OF ZONE ZERO, THAT INCLUDES THE WEST SIDE OF THE STREET ON PIEDMONT AS WELL AS THE EAST SIDE?

>> CORRECT.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU. MY FINAL QUESTION IS ON THOSE BLOCKS WEST OF GRIZZLY PEAK, A LOT OF PEOPLE ARE LIVING IN G.L.A.'S AND LARGE HOUSES AND ARE ORGANIZED KIND OF NON-TRADITIONALLY. SO I'M CURIOUS WHAT THE OUTREACH WILL BE TO THOSE GREEK LIFE HOUSES AND CO OP HOUSES AND HIGH-DENSITY APARTMENTS WHICH ARE DIFFERENT FROM THE ZONE ZERO.

>> ARE YOU TALKING IN AND AROUND PIEDMONT, OFF CAMPUS AREA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YEAH.

>> GREAT QUESTION. ONE OF THE PROPOSALS, ONE OF THE THINGS WE ARE GOING TO DO QUICKLY IF THIS PASSES IS CONSOLIDATE ALL OF OUR RESOURCES FROM PROVIDING SUPPORT AND INSPECTION OF 9,000 HOMES TO ABOUT 850. SO MUCH MORE INDIVIDUALIZED SUPPORT, NEIGHBORHOOD SUPPORT, SUPPORT TO THE GREEK COMMUNITY, CO-OP COMMUNITY. THAT'S THE PLAN, I THINK WE WILL BE IN A MUCH BETTER POSITION TO HELP

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PEOPLE FIGURE OUT WHAT TO DO.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: OKAY, THANK YOU. I WOULD LOVE TO BE A PARTNER IN THAT TOO IF WE WANT TO DO SOME SORT OF EVENT OR OUTREACH.

>> THANKS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. WE ARE NOW GOING TO COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT, FOR FOLKS ENTERING, WE ARE STILL IN OUR SPECIAL MEETING. WE HAVEN'T ENTERED OUR REGULAR MEETING. IF YOU COULD TURN OFF YOUR PHONE AND REDUCE YOUR CONVERSATIONS TO A MINIMUM SO WE CAN FINISH UP HERE, THANK YOU.

>> M. HUMBERT: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. AND THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBERS WHO SPOKE BEFORE ME. I WANT TO PROFOUNDLY THANK OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR ALL THE WORK THAT YOU'VE ACCOMPLISHED ON THESE ITEMS. AND I ALSO WANT TO, YOU KNOW, ACKNOWLEDGE THE YEARS-LONG WORK THAT FORMER COUNCILMEMBER WENGRAF HAS DONE ON THESE ISSUES. SHE HAS BEEN A HERO THAT COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY IS A WORTHY SUCCESSOR TO HER. I KNOW IT'S BEEN A HIGH URGENCY AND AT TIMES FRAUGHT PROCESS TO BRING THIS FORWARD. BUT IT'S EXTREMELY IMPORTANT AND TIMELY WORK. AND WE ARE LUCKY TO HAVE A FIRE DEPARTMENT THAT IS CONSCIENTIOUS AND PROACTIVE. IT'S JUST INCREDIBLE EXAMPLE OF THAT. UNDERSTAND A LOT OF PEOPLE ARE CONCERNED ABOUT THE COST AND IMPACTS ASSOCIATED WITH THESE BEEFED-UP REQUIREMENTS BUT THE COST AND IMPACT OF WILDFIRE WOULD BE MULTIPLE TIMES, FAR MORE CATASTROPHIC. AS WE SAW IN LOS

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ANGELES, FIRES CAN MOVE WITH SCARY AND EXTRAORDINARY SPEED AND DESTRUCTIVENESS AND CAN EVEN SPREAD INTO AREAS THAT WERE THOUGHT TO BE LOWER RISK. WE SAW THAT ALSO IN SANTA ROSA A FEW YEARS AGO. AND IF THE CONDITIONS ARE TOO EXTREME AND I THINK SANTA ROSA WAS AN EXAMPLE OF THESE ROLLING SORT OF EMBER FIRES. IF THE CONDITIONS ARE TOO EXTREME CERTAIN ATTACK METHODS WILL NOT BE AVAILABLE.

>> AND IF THE CONDITIONS ARE TOO EXTREME, SANTA ROSA IS AN EXAMPLE OF THESE EMBER ROLLING FIRES, IF THE CONDITIONS ARE TOO EXTREME, CERTAIN TRADITIONAL ATTACK METHODS WILL NOT BE AVAILABLE. AS MUCH AS WE WORRY ABOUT THE EFFECT THESE REGULATIONS WILL HAVE ON OUR HOMES AND NEIGHBORHOODS, THE EFFECT OF A FIRE AGAIN WILL BE LONG-LASTING AND MUCH WORSE. WE CAN'T ANY LONGER, UNFORTUNATELY, ASSUME WE WILL RECEIVE ANY FEDERAL ASSISTANCE AFTER DISASTER WITH THE CONSTRUCTION COSTS AND TARIFFS WILL BE WHAT THEY ARE NOW WILL BE EXTENSIVE AND DRAWN OUT. IT'S IMPERATIVE THAT WE TAKE THE STEPS NOW TO PREVENT FIRES AND KEEP THEM FROM SPREADING. THAT SAID, I UNDERSTAND NEIGHBORS' CONCERNS AS WELL. WE DON'T WANT TO BE WHOLESALE REMOVING MATURE HEALTHY TREES IF WE CAN POSSIBLY AVOID IT. ALTHOUGH THAT PARTICULAR PROBLEM TREES LIKE PINE NEED TO GO NO MATTER WHAT. OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT HAS WORKED TO ENSURE THESE NEW REGULATIONS HELP MAKE OUR COUNTRIES SAFER WHILE NOT REQUIRING THEIR

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AUTOMATIC REMOVAL. I THINK THIS IS A REASONABLE APPROACH AND I TRUST THE FIRE DEPARTMENT TO EXERCISE THEIR PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT AS THEY EXPECT PROPERTIES AND OFFER REMEDIATION DIRECTIVES. ALL THIS SAID, IT'S JUST THE FIRST STEP IN WHAT WILL BE A LONG PROCESS OF INSPECTION AND VEGETATION METHODS AND HOME HARDENING. IT WILL BE IMPORTANT THAT WE HEAR FROM RESIDENTS AND THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AS WE MOVE FORWARD THROUGH THIS PROCESS OVER THE NEXT COUPLE OF YEARS TO UNDERSTAND WHAT IS WORKING, WHAT ISN'T, WHAT NEEDS TO BE IMPROVED. WE KNOW WE HAVE MANY PEOPLE IN THE FIRE ZONES WHO ARE HOUSE RICH AND CASH POOR. I'VE SEEN THAT, YOU KNOW, WALKING AROUND THE HILLS JUST LOOKING AT THE HOMES. SO I ALSO FULLY SUPPORT FINDING WAYS TO OFFER FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE OR NO OR LOW INTEREST LOANS TO HOMEOWNERS WHO CAN'T AFFORD TO REMOVE VEGETATION ON THEIR OWN. OVERALL, I THINK WE NEED TO MOVE FORWARD BY GIVING THE FIRE DEPARTMENT THE DIRECTION AND TOOLS THAT THEY NEED TO BEGIN WHAT WILL LIKELY BE A YEARS LONG PROCESS. SO ONCE AGAIN, A HUGE THANK YOU TO CHIEF SPRAG, CHIEF ARNOLD, AND EVERYONE AT THE DEPARTMENT WHO WORKED TIRELESSLY ON THIS EFFORT. I'M DEEPLY GRATEFUL TO YOU. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. [LOST AUDIO]

>> S. O'KEEFE: I THINK IT SAYS SO MUCH ABOUT HOW BEAUTIFUL THIS COMMUNITY IS AND I LOVE BERKELEY SO MUCH. I THINK I SAY THAT EVERY MEETING. BUT I DO AND I'M REALLY FEELING IT RIGHT NOW. I'M

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SO PROUD OF US. I'M SO PROUD OF EVERYONE WILLING TO SACRIFICE FOR THE GREATER GOOD. EVEN THOSE WHO ARE AGAINST IT. EVERYONE IS ROOTED IN CARING FOR THEIR COMMUNITY AND I FEEL SO STRONGLY ABOUT THAT. ALSO, I WANT TO THANK IN ADVANCE THE PEOPLE IN THE HIGHER FIRE ZONE WHO ARE GOING TO BE SUBJECT TO THIS BECAUSE, YOU KNOW, I LIVE DOWN THE HILL FROM THAT AND ALSO THE HOME IS IN THE SHADOW OF THE HIGH FIRE ZONE EAST OF GRIZZLY PEAK. AND YOU KNOW, WE SAW, IT WAS A WHILE AGO NOW, BUT WE SAW THAT MAP THAT CHIEF ARNOLD PUT UP OF THE LAHAINA FIRE AND IT SHOWED THAT ONE TRULY FIRE SAFE COMMUNITY ALMOST PROTECTED EVERYONE TO THE NORTH OF IT. IT'S NOT JUST ABOUT PROTECTING THOSE HOMES, IT'S ABOUT PROTECTING OUR ENTIRE CITY AND I EXPRESS SO MUCH GRATITUDE FOR THOSE WHO DO THIS WORK. THANK YOU SO MUCH AS YOU COULD SAVE ALL OF US. LASTLY, I REALLY WANT TO THANK THE CHIEFS AND DEPARTMENT FOR YOUR HARD WORK. CHIEF SPRAG SAID EARLIER THEY DON'T HAVE THE RESOURCES TO FIND A FIRE OF THIS MAGNITUDE. THEY JUST DON'T. BUT FIGHTING FIRES COMES IN MANY FORMS. AND I WANT EVERYONE TO APPRECIATE THAT WHAT EVERYONE IS DOING NOW IS FIGHTING THIS FIRE. I JUST WANT TO THANK YOU. YOU ARE DOING YOUR JOBS. YOU ARE DOING IT AS EXCELLENT AS ALWAYS. I LOVE HAVING A FIRE DEPARTMENT WHO CARES EVERYONE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE. COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB.

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>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU. JUST WANTED TO ASK TWO QUESTIONS. ALL OF MY OTHER QUESTIONS WERE ANSWERED. THERE WAS A MEMBER OF THE PUBLIC THAT ASKED ABOUT UNUSUAL CONDITIONS SUCH AS STEEP SLOPES AND HOW THAT MAY OR MAY NOT IMPACT THE 5 FOOT SETBACK REQUIREMENT. I WANTED TO ASK THAT AS WELL AS ANOTHER MEMBER OF THE PUBLIC WHO WROTE IN AND ALSO SPOKE IN PERSON ASKING ABOUT I GUESS THEIR HOME IS ON A PART OF THE MAP THAT APPEARS TO BE DIFFERENT FROM SOME OF THE HIGHER FIRE ZONE CONDITIONS. SO I THINK THAT QUESTION IS JUST HOW MUCH FLEXIBILITY WILL THERE CONTINUE TO BE IN THE MAPS FOR THE REFINEMENT.

>> TO THE FIRST QUESTION IN TERMS OF PLANT SPACING OR WHAT CAN BE INCLUDED IN THE 5 FOOT ZONE, 5 FOOT ZONE APPLIES UNIVERSALLY IRREGARDLESS OF THE SLOPE. SO 5 FEET OUT FROM THE HOUSE THE REGULATIONS ARE, AS CHIEF ARNOLD EXPLAINED, IN TERMS OF OUT TO 100 FEET. CAL FIRE DOES PROVIDE SPACING. SPACING BETWEEN TREES, SPACING BETWEEN SHRUBS. THAT INVOLVES PRUNING AND THINNING TREES. BUT THAT'S EXISTING LANGUAGE AT THE STATE LEVEL, WHICH WE HAVE ALREADY ADOPTED AND WILL HAVE TO ADOPT AS A MINIMUM. THAT ANSWER THE FIRST QUESTION?

>> I. TREGUB: YES, THANK YOU.

>> AND I'M NOT CLEAR ON THE SECOND QUESTION.

>> I. TREGUB: HOW MUCH REFINEMENT MIGHT THERE BE IN THE MAPS POST APPROVAL FOR THESE ONE-OFF CONDITIONS.

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>> OH, YOU'RE TALKING ABOUT THE PHASING. THE PHASING IS VERY CONCEPTUAL. WE SPENT MOST OF OUR TIME FOCUSED ON THE GRIZZLY PEAK AND PARENT MITIGATION ZONES. I AGREE THERE'S A LOT MORE WORK THAT NEEDS TO BE DONE AS WE CONSIDER BRINGING IN ADDITIONAL PHASES MOVING DOWN THE HILL TO COUNCIL. WE HAVE TO ADOPT THAT AS A MINIMUM. OTHER THAN THAT, LOCAL DISCRETION APPLIES.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU. AND THEN ALL VERY TOUGH ACT TO FOLLOW. AS A FLATLANDER I WILL TRYING TO BE AS BRIEF AS I CAN. I THINK I MADE SOME OF THESE COMMENTS AT THE INITIAL MEETING WE HAD ON THE QUESTION. I COME FROM A BACKGROUND OF 13 YEARS IN NUCLEAR SAFETY RIVERSIDE. I HAVE SEEN SOME PRETTY SCARY FIRE PROGRESSION SEQUENCES AND WHEN I MET AND MY STAFF MET WITH THE FIRE CHIEF, THE FIRE PROGRESSION SEQUENCE YOU SHOWED ME WAS ONE OF THE SCARIEST THINGS I'VE EVER SEEN IN MY LIFE. I HAD A GRAD SCHOOL CLASSMATE WHO WAS DEEPLY IMPACTED BY THE AFTERMATH OF THE LAHAINA FIRE. I HAD JUST COME BACK FROM A LOCAL ELECTIONS -- IN THE PASADENA AREA WHO LOST HIS HOME. NOT THAT LONG AGO I TRAVELED TO THE TOWN OF PARADISE TO TRY TO SUPPORT THEIR LOCAL ECONOMY. THEY ARE CERTAIN REBUILDING, BUT FOR MANY THAT IS A PARADISE THAT WILL IRRETRIEVABLY BE LOST. THIS PAST WEEK INCLUDING YESTERDAY WE HAD A VERY UNFORTUNATE SITUATION IN MY DISTRICT INVOLVING TWO FIRES. AND I THINK THE FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR THE LIGHTNING QUICK RESPONSE, THE FIRST ONE HAPPENED LAST

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WEEK AND WAS TWO BLOCKS AWAY FROM WHERE I LIVE. SO I WAS WALKING OUT WHEN I JUST HAPPENED TO SEE THE LIGHTNING QUICK RESPONSE I THINK THERE WERE FIVE TRUCKS. THERE MAY HAVE BEEN SEVEN. AND THAT IS HOW WE WERE ABLE TO, I MEAN THE FIRE DEPARTMENT WAS ABLE TO STOP THAT FIRE BEFORE IT PROGRESSED INTO SOMETHING MUCH SCARIER. BUT WHAT WE'RE TALKING ABOUT WITH THE POTENTIAL FOR THESE KINDS OF SITUATIONS IN ZONE ZERO, IF YOU HAVE 5-7 FIRE ENGINES DEALING WITH MULTIPLE HOMES THAT ARE INVOLVED, THERE'S JUST NOT ENOUGH FIRETRUCKS IN BERKELEY LET ALONE THE REGION TO ADDRESS THAT. FOR ALL THESE REASONS I STRONGLY, STRONGLY SUPPORT THIS ITEM. AND I WOULD LIKE TO THANK CERTAINLY THE ENTIRE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT AS WELL AS MY COLLEAGUES COUNCILMEMBERS BLACKABY, O'KEEFE, HUMBERT, AND ALL OF [LOST AUDIO]

>> [INDISCERNIBLE] [LOST AUDIO] [NO AUDIO] [STANDBY]

>> LET'S SEE. ACTUALLY, HOLD ON. I GUESS IT'S PICKING UP THE COUNCIL OKAY. YOU CAN SEE. WELL, ACTUALLY, LET'S SEE IF THIS IS BETTER ACTUALLY. I THINK THAT'S MAYBE BETTER. ALL RIGHT. WILL YOU GO STOP THE VIDEO ON THE ZOOM COMPUTER? LEAVE THE AUDIO ON JUST IN CASE. JUST STOP THE VIDEO. HEY, MARK?

>> YES?

>> THIS IS SCOTT. JUST WANT TO MAKE SURE YOU KNOW THEY CAN HEAR YOU.

>> YES.

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>> THANK YOU, SCOTT. OKAY. AND WE'RE RECORDING. OKAY.

>> HI, EVERYBODY. I APOLOGIZE FOR INTERRUPTING YOUR CONVERSATIONS, AND I REALLY APOLOGIZE FOR THIS SUPERLONG BREAK. OUR SYSTEMS ARE NOT WITH OUR OWL OVER HERE. WE WERE FINISHING UP COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB'S COMMENTS. I HAVE SOME BRIEF COMMENTS AND THEN WE ARE GOING TO TAKE A VOTE. THEN WE ARE GOING TO TRY TO RESET OUR SYSTEMS. I REALLY APOLOGIZE. THANK YOU TO OUR CLERK. OKAY. I'M SORRY. IF WE CAN HAVE QUIET, PLEASE. THANK YOU. SO ARE WE GOING TO JUST YELL? IS THAT WHAT'S THE PLAN? OKAY. WE'RE GOING TO USE OUTSIDE VOICES. OKAY. GO AHEAD. ARE WE READY TO GO? MR. CITY CLERK?

>> YES.

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: YES. SO COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB CAN BEGIN?

>> I. TREGUB: OKAY. WHERE WAS I? SINCE FORMER COUNCILMEMBER WENGRAF IS JOINING US IN PERSON, I WANT TO EXTEND APPRECIATION LEADERSHIP. [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: YES. I JUST WANTED TO THANK THE FIRE CHIEF, ASSISTANT FIRE CHIEF AND FIRE MARSHAL FOR ALL THE WORK THAT'S GONE INTO THIS. I ALSO WANT TO ECHO WHAT SOME OF MY COLLEAGUES SAID ABOUT BEING REALLY INSPIRED BY WILLINGNESS OF MEMBERS OF OUR COMMUNITY DOING THEIR PART TO KEEP OUR ENTIRE COMMUNITY SAFE. I'M FULLY IN SUPPORT AND READY TO VOTE. THANK YOU.

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>> MAYOR A. ISHII: ANY OTHER COMMENTS FROM COUNCILMEMBERS?

>> WE CAN'T HEAR YOU.

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: I KNOW. I'M SORRY. OUR MIC'S ARE NOT WORKING RIGHT NOW. I'M GOING TO SPEAK AS LOUD AS I CAN. ACTUALLY, I'M GOING TO STAND. I WANT TO THANK CHIEF SPRAG AND ARNOLD. I'M SO IMPRESSED BY HOW MUCH HAS GONE INTO THIS. I KNOW IT'S BEEN GOING ON FOR A REALLY LONG TIME, SO I WANT TO MAKE SURE FOLKS UNDERSTAND THAT. IT DOESN'T MEAN THIS WORK HASN'T GONE ON FOR A VERY ROUGH TIME. I ALSO WANT TO THANK COUNCILMEMBER WENGRAF AND YOUR WORK TO ENGAGE THE COMMUNITY. I KNOW YOU HELD MANY COMMUNITY MEETINGS. THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR ALL THE FOLKS WHO GAVE COMMENTS. I ACKNOWLEDGE THAT SOME OF THESE COMMENTS ARE REALLY PERSONAL, SO I WANT TO THANK YOU FOR YOUR VULNERABILITY AND SHARING. I'M SUPER PROUD OF OUR COMMUNITY FOR ORGANIZING AND BEING OPEN-MINDED IN OUR COMMUNITY. I KNOW THIS WORK IS CHALLENGING FOR SOME OF YOU THIS AS BEEN KIND OF PAINFUL. I WANT TO JUST SAY YES AND. IT IS A YES -- AND COLLABORATION WITH PARKING ENFORCEMENT AND EARLY EVACUATION AND DOWN POWER LINES. -- I JUST WANT TO MAKE SURE YOU KNOW THAT WE ARE ALL PAYING ATTENTION TO THAT. I'M COMMITTED TO HELPING COMMUNITY MEMBERS FIND FUNDING TO SUPPORT THE WORK THAT NEEDS TO BE DONE CLARIFYING THAT MEASURE FF IS NOT THE REASON WHITE INFRASTRUCTURE GOT PASSED, BUT THE FIRE ONE. I'M COMMITTED TO

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HELPING THOSE IN NEED. I WANT TO THANK YOU ALL SO MUCH AND WITH THAT I KNOW WE HAVE GOT A MOTION ON THE FLOOR. I'M GOING TO HAVE THE CLERK TAKE THE ROLL.

>> CITY CLERK: YES, AND JUST TO CLARIFY THE MOTION, THIS IS ITEMS ONE AND TWO AS THEY ARE IN THE SUPPLEMENTAL ITEMS THAT WERE ACCEPTED TONIGHT.

>> CORRECT.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. CALLING THE ROLE ON THE MOTION. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN.

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT.

>> B. BARTLETT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB.

>> YES.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY.

>> B. BLACKABY: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT.

>> M. HUMBERT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA.

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>> C. LUNAPARRA: YES.

>> MAYOR A. ISHII: IF WE ARE ALL AGREED ON THIS, THIS MEETING IS ADJOURNED. AGAIN, I'M SO SORRY, FOLKS, FOR THOSE OF YOU THAT ARE WAITING FOR OUR REGULAR MEETING. WE ARE TRYING TO FIX THE SITUATION WITH OUR MICS SO FOLKS ONLINE CAN HEAR US AND BE ACCESSIBLE WITH OUR MEETINGS. I KNOW SOME OF YOU ARE HERE FOR PROCLAMATIONS. I KNOW I APPRECIATE YOU WAITING. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

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